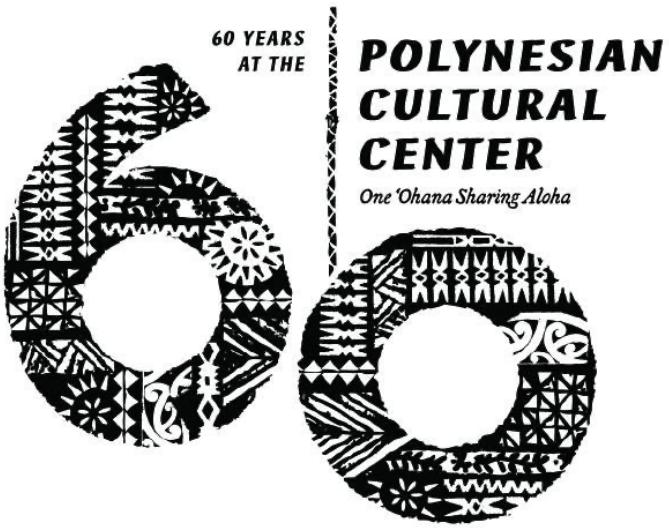


Ambassador Tour Script

Revised: April 2026

The Privilege to Serve

"Anyone can be a tour guide. It doesn't take very much. Anyone can come in off of the street, read the script, walk around the villages, learn the lingo, and figure out how to be 'good enough'.

*"But to become a '**Great** Tour Guide' requires much more.*

"It requires the Spirit. It requires hard work.
It takes passion, dedication to your craft, and a true love of people.
It requires a strong desire to serve and the ability to genuinely care for those around you.

"Being a Tour Guide at the Polynesian Cultural Center is much more than 'just a job'. It's the opportunity to represent your family, the Center, & the Church as you interact and create deep, long-lasting connections with people from all around the world. It's a blessing that allows us to serve as Ambassadors to the nations of the Earth, without ever having to leave our island paradise. No, it's not 'just a job'. It's the privilege to share joy and happiness with God's children.

"What kind of Tour Guide will you be?"

AMBASSADOR TOURS:

Ambassador guides have the great opportunity of representing the Polynesian Cultural Center and the Church in their one-on-one contact with the guests. The facts found in the tour script are meant to ensure that each guest receives the finest and most comprehensive information on the cultures of the Pacific. However, once the information in the script is learned, guides should use their own personalities and abilities in the presentation to personalize the experience for guests. The following list of characteristics, abilities & skills describe ***excellence*** in this position. While anyone can pick up a script, map & show schedule and be a decent tour guide, these are the things that make us EXCELLENT.

10 CHARACTERISTICS OF A EXCELLENT TOUR GUIDE:

An Excellent Tour Guide …

1. **… is committed to give his/her all to the PCC every day!**
    - **a.** Align your daily actions to help reach our company goals.
    - **b.** Love what you do and those you do it for.

2. **… is Professional**
    - **a.** Be punctual and responsible for your work schedule.
    - **b.** Be Courteous, attentive & sincere.
    - **c.** Act as a dignified representative of the PCC.
    - **d.** Look the part & follow the PCC Dress & Grooming Standards.

3. **… is Prepared in Advance**
    - **a.** Excel at your job by knowing what you need to know and how to effectively share it.
    - **b.** Be well-prepared and well-practiced.
    - **c.** Anticipate guests' needs and know how to meet them.

4. **… Stands Out in a Crowd**
    - **a.** Be memorable! Be unique!
    - **b.** Become part of the PCC experience, not just a moderator of it.
    - **c.** Speak loudly and clearly so everyone can hear and understand.
    - **d.** Look good! Look sharp! Look alive!

5. **… has Great Communication Skills**
    - **a.** Speak fluently & eloquently.
    - **b.** Use proper vocabulary that shows respect to our customers.
    - **c.** Use appropriate and effective Non-Verbal Communication.
        - **i.** Smile! Be enthusiastic!
        - **ii.** Maintain proper eye contact.
        - **iii.** Use appropriate body language.

6. **… Provides Pertinent & Accurate Information to Guests**
    - **a.** Know the script, be knowledgeable
    - **b.** Inform guests of everything they need to know … and more!
    - **c.** Try new things. Learn new things. Experience new things. Share them!
    - **d.** When you don't know the answer to a question, say, "That's a great question! Let me find out the answer for you!"
        - **i.** When necessary, write down guests' questions and contact information, then follow-up with answers.

7. **<u>… Builds Relationships and Rapport with Guests</u>**
    - **a.** Learn about guests in order to build relationships of trust.
        - **i.** Know your guests' names, where they are from, what they're doing in Hawaii, what kinds of things they are expecting from their visit with us at the PCC, etc.
    - **b.** Use universally relevant ideas, principles and values to make examples more personal.

8. **<u>… has a Structure for Every Tour & Manages the Group Well</u>**
    - **a.** Plan out the day's agenda & prepare contingency plans for any unforeseen circumstances.
    - **b.** Find out what guests want to do, then plan the best schedule to meet their needs.

9. **<u>... makes the Tour Dynamic & Immersive</u>**
    - **a.** Use games, hands-on activities, & demonstrations (avoid basing tours on lectures only).
    - **b.** Use natural objects, artifacts & other props when appropriate.
    - **c.** Allow guests to interact with the villagers.
    - **d.** Keep guests excited and enthusiastic throughout the day.

10. **<u>… has a Genuine Love for the Polynesian Cultural Center, it's unique Mission, & the people we serve!</u>**

TOUR ORIENTATION: Meeting, Greeting & Orienteering Guests

Required Elements of Tour Introduction & Orientation:

A. Official Welcome to the Polynesian Cultural Center!

Be energetic, happy and sincere. Remember to start your tour off by making a great first impression. As they are introduced to you, shake each guests' hand and welcome them to the Center. Welcome your guests to the Polynesian Cultural Center by presenting them with their lei. This traditional Hawaiian gift is given as a symbol of love, respect, or appreciation. Guides should take the time to explain the deeper meaning of the lei so that it is seen as more than "just a Hawaiian necklace", but a gift that should be treasured. Each one is hand-woven, and represents the spirit of Aloha or love. Explain that we share it today in honor of their visit and hope they keep it as a memory of their day here.

B. Brief Self-Introduction & Get-to-know Your Guests

Your name, where you're from, and what you're studying in school. Share with guests the reason you became a tour guide and tell them why you're excited to be able to take them on tour today.

C. Explain the Mission and Purpose of PCC

Briefly share with guests the reason the PCC was established (Mission Statement)

D. Ticket explanation

Explain the different portions of the ticket, including dinner, night show seating, and temple tour. Make sure guests are dining in the venue of their choosing and if not, show them to the Box Office where they can change their tickets (based on availability at the lu'au.)

E. Free within 3 Admission

All guests who purchase any full-day package or General Admission may return to the Center and be admitted for free for up to three days from the date of the original visit. They simply show their original ticket at the Box Office on their return visit and a picture ID to receive new admission tickets which can be used to enter the Center. (Does not include Late Entry packages.)

F. Overview of the Day

Give a brief description of what guests can expect on their tour with you. Use this opportunity to get guests excited about what they'll see and do. Tell them about the cultural presentations, lectures and hands-on activities you anticipate doing. Also include bathroom breaks, shopping and snack shops for something to eat and drink.

G. Check for Special Needs or Requests

Do any of your guests need wheelchairs? Strollers? Do they have bags they need to store in the lockers? Do they need water bottle, sun screen, batteries, disposable camera, etc. What can you do to help them enjoy their experience even before the tour starts?

H. Express gratitude for their visit

Sincerely express gratitude for their visit because their coming makes the educational dreams of thousands come true!

Aloha: Not Just a Greeting

Aloha is our most important Hawaiian cultural value. Without Aloha all the other cultural values are not complete. Aloha is a noun meaning love, affection, compassion, charity, grace, empathy, and much more. It is also a verb meaning to love, show affection, give compassion, to be charitable, and so forth. Aloha is also used as a greeting and salutation. It doesn't necessarily mean hello and goodbye, but it is used in the same way that Good morning, Good afternoon, or Good evening can be used to say hello and goodbye in English.

Good morning: Aloha kakahiaka

Good afternoon: Aloha ʻauinalā

Good evening: Aloha ahiahi

The proper use of the word is often misused in that many people will try to hold the "o" sound of Aloha longer. Hawaiian is a penultimate language meaning that the second to the last syllable is a natural stress on a word. However, the longer you hold the "O" sound, the less Hawaiian it becomes. Even her majesty, Queen Lili'uokalani was known to reprimand people, even some Hawaiians, telling them that the word aloha should not be pronounced with the long "O" sound.

Some Interesting Facts about the PCC:

Totals Updated (April '15)

- More than 50 million visitors have come to the PCC since we opened on **October 12, 1963**.
- The PCC has contributed nearly $310 million toward the education of BYU-Hawaii students.
- Nearly 25,000 BYU-H students have supplemented their educational expenses by working at PCC.
- Over 800 BYU-Hawaii students currently work at the Center each semester, augmenting their formal education with practical experience.
- Over 500 of the BYU-Hawaii student workers are on the International Work Experience Scholarship program which allows them to be "sponsored" by the Polynesian Cultural Center. In exchange for working 19 hours each week, tuition, room and board is fully paid by the PCC so they can earn their way through school.
- In addition, the Polynesian Cultural Center is a non-profit organization, which donates all the money that isn't used to run operations over to Brigham Young University Hawai'i to subsidize its expenses, thereby benefiting ALL students going to school there – not just the ones who work here.
- Elvis Presley visited the PCC in 1965 to film his full-length feature film, "*Paradise Hawaiian Style*". He loved an original PCC tune called "Bula La'ie", which was written by Israeli Racule, Chief of the Fijian village at the time, and requested permission to write his own lyrics for it. He rebranded it under the name, "Drums of the Islands". The famous scene from the last 5 minutes of the movie in which the tune was used, was filmed in what is now the "Hale Aloha", home of the Ali'i Luau.

- One of the more visible and vibrant part of Laie's famous hukilau celebration was a man named Hamana Kalili, who was born and raised right here in La'ie, from 1882 to 1958. When the Hawaiian royal court was presented at these special Hukilau events, Hamana was there to do his best presentation of King Kamehameha. The entire royal court was presented, including all the princesses and princes for each island, but the most memorable image was Hamana.

Hamana Kalili at the Hukilau

Hamana was also known as the father of the shaka sign. He had lost his three middle fingers on one of his hands. When he waved to people, he held up the hand that only had a thumb and a pinky finger. The wave caught on, and the rest is history. How he lost the fingers is the subject of local legend. One story suggests they were bitten off by a shark that was interested in the fish Hamana held while fishing underwater. Another rumor proposes that the fingers were blown off while he was fishing the easy way - with dynamite. However, Von Logan, grand-nephew of Hamana, says that his fingers were accidentally amputated in a sugar mill accident. After the accident, the plantation owners decided to give Hamana a new job -- security. His job was to watch the trains because the locals kids would 'jump on the train' as it slowed down entering or leaving Kahuku. He would yell or wave at them to get off the train--and if he caught them, they would get in big trouble with the mill. Eventually what happened was the kids adopted his 'wave', or what we now call the shaka sign, as an 'all clear' or 'go for it' sign! When they used the gesture, it meant that Hamana was not around and everything was 'okay' to jump onto the train. Hamana was also a chorister or choir leader in the local church and would lead the congregation singing hymns with his 'shaka' sign.

A few years later a very popular local politician named Frank Fasi adopted the sign and started using the gesture in advertisements and it became his signature signage, helping it gain even more popularity. He served as the Mayor of Honolulu, and used the shaka sign in all of his advertisement for twenty-two years, and held various public offices in Hawaii from 1952 to 2004 (more than 50 years).

Just as these stories live on, so does the shaka sign - a homegrown symbol of Laie's famous hukilau festivals.

Source: David Parker, Hawaiian Historian, and Von Logan, the grand nephew of Hamana Kalili and recorded by Bob Krauss of the Honolulu Advertiser.

In 2015, a heroic proportioned statue of Hamana Kalili, sculpted by former PCC student employee Leroy Transfield, a Maori of New Zealand, was officially unveiled during the opening ceremonies for the Polynesian Cultural Center's new Hukilau Marketplace. He stands day and night as the first one to greet thousands of visitors, and employees alike, each new day.

INTRODUCTION OF POLYNESIA

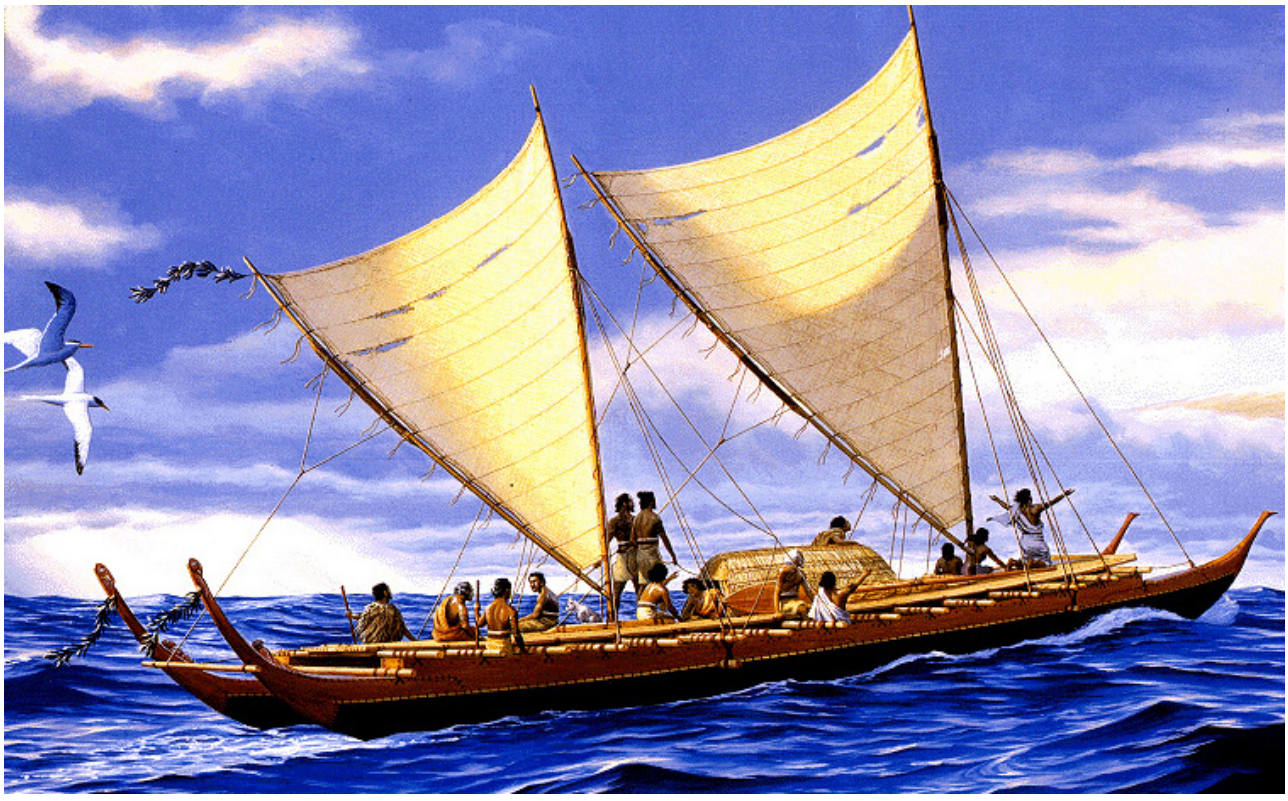
In 1000 A.D. (492 years before Columbus set sail on his first expedition) Polynesian explorers are in the midst of settling the Marquesas and Hawaii.

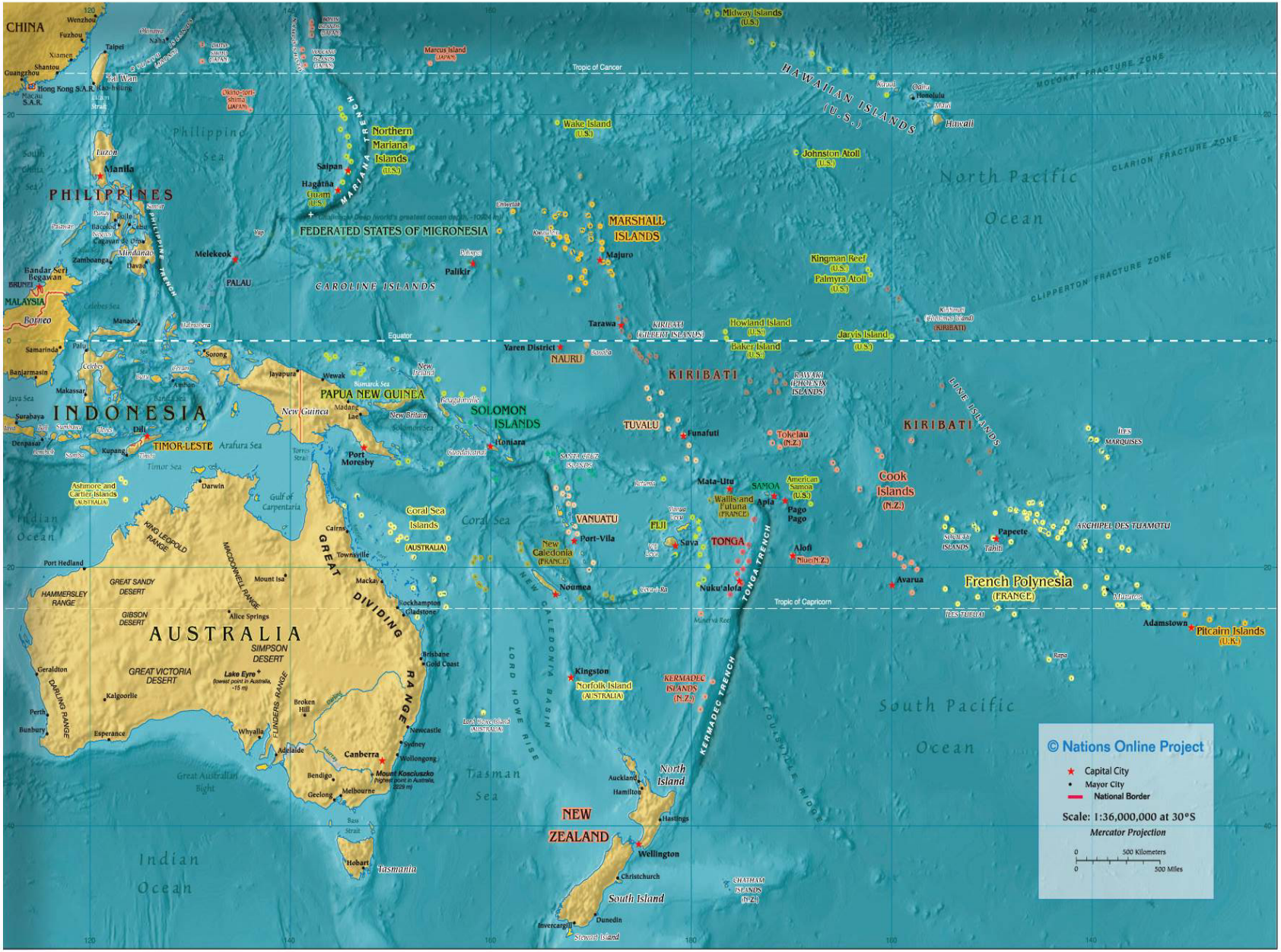
Dr. Terry Hunt, Archeologist at the University of Hawaii says, "Ancient Polynesian voyagers were simply the best. We know they reached every distant island in the Pacific and they did it in a short amount of time." Spread out over nearly 6 million square miles of the Pacific Ocean, Polynesia covers more area than any nation in the world. There are more than 1,000 islands scattered over the central and southern region of the Pacific Ocean – and by 1380 A.D. Polynesian voyagers managed to travel to and colonize ALL of them, from Hawaii in the north, New Zealand (Aotearoa) in the south, and Easter Island (Rapa Nui) in the east. Samoa, Tonga, the Cook Islands, Tuvalu, Tokelau, Niue, Wallis & Futuna, and French Polynesia are some of the main island groups located within the Polynesian Triangle. There is 600 times more ocean than there is land here."

Dr. James Delgado, Archeologist from the Institute of Nautical Archeology, said this:

"If you look at world maritime history and you ask who the most successful navigators were and the most successful types of ships, very few people would give you the correct answer – which is 'the Polynesian sea-going canoe and Polynesian navigators'."

Polynesians were able to island hop across the Pacific, using what many would consider to be the most primitive ships, with very little by way of navigational tools and instruments. They used the winds, the clouds, and the stars to chart their way from island to island, without even having a written language.

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Midway Islands (U.S.)
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Kingman Reef (U.S.)
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Baker Island (U.S.)
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Cook Islands (N.Z.)
French Polynesia (FRANCE)
Pitcairn Islands (U.K.)
Tokelau (N.Z.)
Niue (N.Z.)
American Samoa (U.S.)
SAMOA
Wallis and Futuna (FRANCE)
New Caledonia (FRANCE)
Norfolk Island (AUSTRALIA)
KERMADEC ISLANDS (N.Z.)
CHATHAM ISLANDS (N.Z.)
Coral Sea Islands (AUSTRALIA)
Lord Howe Island (AUSTRALIA)
Tasmania
Tropic of Cancer
Tropic of Capricorn
Equator
Philippine Sea
Coral Sea
Tasman Sea
North Pacific Ocean
South Pacific Ocean
Indian Ocean
Arafura Sea
Timor Sea
Great Australian Bight
MARIANA TRENCH
PHILIPPINE TRENCH
TONGA TRENCH
KERMADEC TRENCH
CLARION FRACTURE ZONE
CLIPPERTON FRACTURE ZONE
MOLOKAI FRACTURE ZONE
LINE ISLANDS
TUAMOTU ARCHIPELAGO
GREAT DIVIDING RANGE
CAROLINE ISLANDS
Manila
Taipei
Hong Kong S.A.R.
Macau S.A.R.
Jakarta
Port Moresby
Canberra
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Adelaide
Auckland
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Christchurch
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Papeete
Tahiti
Funafuti
Tarawa
Majuro
Palikir
Koror
Saipan
Hagåtña
Melekeok
Dili
Kupang
Surabaya
Jayapura
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Madang
Rabaul
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Gizo
Kingston
Alofi
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Adamstown
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Kiritimati (Christmas Island) (KIRIBATI)
Teraina (Fanning Island) (KIRIBATI)
Starbuck Island (KIRIBATI)
Malden Island (KIRIBATI)
Flint Island (KIRIBATI)
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Caroline Island (KIRIBATI)
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Iwo Jima (JAPAN)
Chichi-jima (JAPAN)
Haha-jima (JAPAN)
Ashmore and Cartier Islands (AUSTRALIA)
Heard Island and McDonald Islands (AUSTRALIA)
Macquarie Island (AUSTRALIA)
Lake Eyre (lowest point in Australia, -15 m)
Mount Kosciuszko (highest point in Australia, 2228 m)
Challenger Deep (world's greatest ocean depth, -10924 m)
© Nations Online Project
Capital City
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Scale: 1:36,000,000 at 30°S
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POLYNESIAN CULTURAL CENTER

Samoa

Greeting Word: Talofa
Current Population: 260,000

Samoa and American Samoa – one people spread across two countries – are located about 2,600 miles [4,180 km] southwest of Hawaii. The two major and other smaller islands of Samoa include 1,130 square miles [2,930 km²] of land, while about 77 square miles [199 km²] make up the five volcanic islands and two atolls of American Samoa.

Factoid: The Scottish author Robert Louis Stevenson, or Tusitala, who spent his final years in Samoa and is buried there, dubbed the Samoans the "happy people" because of their enjoyment of life and good spirited nature.

SAMOA & AMERIKA SAMOA

"TALOFA!" is the greeting word in Samoa.

Because Samoa is in the center of the Polynesian triangle, it is referred to as "the Heart of Polynesia." Geographically speaking, there are, in fact, two Samoas. Samoa is an independent country of about 1,130 square miles and includes the islands of Savai'i and Upolu. The other, American Samoa, is a territory of 77 square miles administered by the United States government and includes the eastern islands, primarily Tutuila. The population of Samoa is just under **200,000** and American Samoa has just under **60,000** people. Jacob Roggeveen, a Dutch Explorer, is credited with its discovery in 1722.

Although Samoa is two separate countries, its people, language and culture are one. From 1900 until the First World War, Western Samoa was a German territory. After World War I, it became a trust territory administered for the United Nations by New Zealand. In 1962, Western Samoa became the first independent Polynesian nation.

The constitution of American Samoa defines the basic governmental and legal organization. It provides for executive, legislative and judicial branches. The Governor and Lieutenant Governor head the executive branch and the bicameral legislature is popularly elected.

Samoans are raised in villages, or **nu'u**, such as this one at the Polynesian Cultural Center. The courtyard found in each village is called the **malae** and accommodates the traditional festivities and ceremonies of the village. Each of the structures in a Samoan village serves a special purpose.

Buildings in Samoa are usually rounded in shape with domed roofs. Posts are spaced evenly around each structure with large supporting beams in the center. The Samoans favor round shaped roofs not only for their beauty and symmetry, but also for practical purposes. The round shape allows the rain to quickly run off to the ground with out any obstructions. The dome shaped structure are also durable and up keep is minimal, but most importantly they keep the interior cool and breezy during hot, humid days. Samoa's location near the equator means the weather is often hot and humid, which is why you will notice that none of the buildings have walls.

The breeze comes in off the ocean and helps to cool the occupants. Woven coconut leaf blinds, called **pola**, are attached to the beams of the buildings which can be lowered during strong winds, storms, or when privacy is desired. Roofing materials come from the leaves of the sugar cane plant, some of which are grown here in our plantation. The leaves are bundled together and cleverly attached in rows, round and around, until the whole roof is covered. A first time thatch job will last 10-15 years without repairs – in the absence of excessively strong winds.

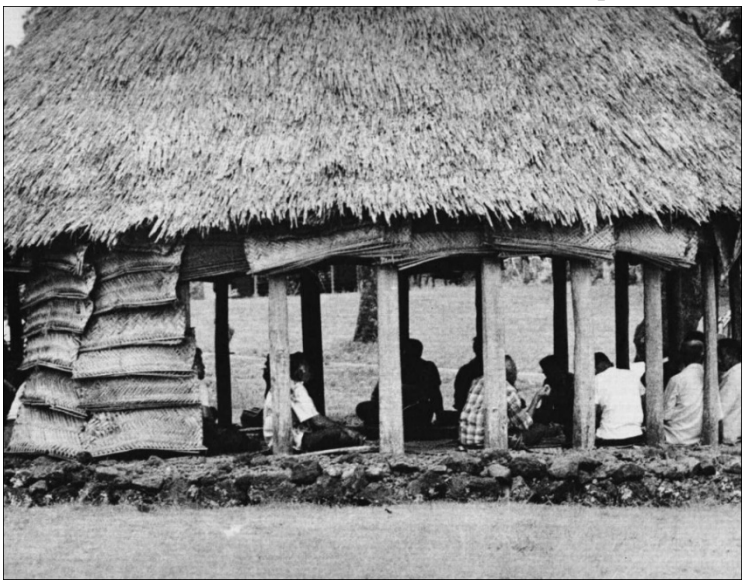


Image: Typical Samoan fale with pola lowered on the right to block wind or rain. Some pola in the raised position can also be seen on the right of the building where the men of the village have gathered to meet.

TUNOA or **UMU KUKA:** Kitchen

In Samoa the kitchen was the man's domain because the preparation and cooking of food was considered a physically demanding job. The Samoan earth oven is a typical hot rock oven, which is laid

out above the ground. The oven utilizes round river or lava rocks that conduct heat extremely well. Four logs are arranged in a square with rocks, and then a fire is built to heat the rocks. When the fire has heated the rocks and they are white with ash, charcoal debris is pushed aside and the food is placed on the heated rocks. Fire resistant leaves are used to protect the food so they are not burnt. The whole oven is then covered with banana leaves and other insulating materials.

Hunting, climbing coconut trees, husking, cracking and milking the coconuts all required physical strength, and the young men of the family show their respect to their parents, grandparents, and women by performing these arduous tasks. The young men prepare the food, and serve their grandparents and parents first. Then the young children eat. Finally, the cooks eat. This service is part of the Samoan Way of Life, or **Fa'a Samoa**, in which respect is taught at a young age. Young men serve their parents and elders in the same way their future children will serve them when they start their own families.

The coconut is one of the most important items in the life of Samoans and other Polynesians. From the various parts of the coconut tree materials for buildings, clothing, and food preparation are obtained. The first step that must be done to use the coconut is to climb the very high tree to get it. Here in the Samoan village, you will be able to see how skillful the young men are at climbing the coconut trees, obtaining the coconuts, husking them and extracting its inner flesh for cooking purposes.

Once husked using a very sharp stick, the actual nut itself appears to have a face on one end. Each coconut appears to have two eyes, a nose, and a mouth. To crack open a coconut, a Samoan uses a heavy object or stone and hits the line that runs across the face. The clear liquid inside the coconut is the juice. Young coconuts that have not begun to produce much inner flesh contain more juice than ripe coconuts. The coconut juice obtained from the very young coconuts is a refreshing drink in Samoa.

How do the Samoans get coconut milk? Inside the coconut is the white meat that can be grated and squeezed through a strainer made from various wood fibers. The white liquid that falls from the grated coconut is coconut milk and is used in all types of Samoan cooking.

Other Samoan staple foods grown in the family garden include sugarcane, bananas, taro, tapioca, sweet potato, breadfruit, and the ava plant. Meats include pork, chicken, fish, and shellfish of all kinds.

FALE NONOFO or **FALE AFOLAU:** Family Dwelling House

The Fale Nonofo is the family dwelling house. **Tapa** is used to partition areas for sleeping. **Fala**, or mats woven from the dried & softened leaves of the pandanus tree, are placed on the floor each night for sleeping on, and rolled up and placed in the rafters each morning. The Fale Nonofo also serves as the eating-place, where the food is served to the family, after being cooked at the tunoa.

As you observe the inside of this building, notice the cultural craftsmanship achieved by skilled workers under the supervision of the master builder. The master builder is responsible not only for the physical

details, but also for the artistry of the building. A building of this size usually takes about 6-8 weeks to complete depending on the number of men working and their skill levels.

This particular structure also serves as a workshop in which men carve and women do arts and crafts. You can try your hand at making fire by rubbing two sticks together as demonstrated by the young men of Samoa.

FALE TALIMALO: Guest House and **FALE FONO:** Meeting House (Same building; different purposes)

Fale Talimalo means "a house to receive guests." Not only pre-arranged guests are welcome to stay here, but also a person or group passing by who needs a place to rest. When pre-arranged groups arrive, the family (immediate or extended or the village) will prepare leis, food and special decorations. A special welcome ceremony would be included if the guest is a high ranking chief.

When unexpected guests arrive, the immediate family will quickly prepare food and water. Bedding is provided if the stay is extended. After the guests are fed and have rested, the chief will inquire as to the purpose of the unexpected visit and the intended length of stay. He will then offer any further assistance as needed.

When not being used to host visitors, this building is also used as the **Fale Fono**, meaning, "meeting house." As a **Fale Fono**, this building is to serve the chiefs of the village as a gathering place to discuss the affairs of the village. The discussions include monitoring the performance of individual families, the safety of all the villagers, each family beautifying their yards, planting food crops and raising meat animals to encourage self-reliance and generally maintaining order in the village.

The posts surrounding the structure have special significance in Samoa. During meetings and ceremonies, participants sit with their backs to a post representing their rank, family, or home village. Some posts are reserved for various people of prestigious rank. The post centered at the left half of the entrance is for the highest-ranking person in the visiting party, usually a chief. The post immediately opposite is for the highest-ranking person of the home village, again usually a chief. The posts on either side of the main entrance post are for the chief's spokesmen known as the talking chiefs. The next two posts on the left are for other local talking chiefs. Other minor participants sit on mats spread around

the outside rim. An interesting custom in Samoa is the fourth post from the left, known as the stranger's post. If a stranger comes into a meeting unannounced and demands it, the post must be surrendered to him. From the three posts in the middle any food to be served during the meeting is dispensed.

The kava ceremony takes place in this building. Not only does it represent the highest form of welcome to guests, it also represents a unity of purpose. The significance lies in each chief drinking from the same coconut cup, representing a solemn commitment to ally himself with the consensus of the council. It is a sign of loyalty and symbolizes the highest ideals of all participants and the village people they represent.

The floor of this building is typical of what is found in Samoa. River pebbles and stones are gathered from the nearby rivers and streams and spread to cover the interior area. The rocks help keep the house cool and dry. If water does seep in, it spreads out under the rocks rather than pooling into hard-to-clean puddles. Mats are placed on top of the rocks to provide comfort. The thicker the layer of mats, the softer the seating area.

Fine mats, or **ie toga**, used for ceremonies in this building, require special weaving skills. The pandanus leaves are cleaned, boiled, and bleached in the sun until the desired shade of whiteness is reached. The leaves are then flattened and left to season for about a week. The weaver then takes a shell or possibly the sharp, hard wing of a coconut beetle and cuts the leaves into fine strands for weaving. Some of the mats are woven so fine that they have the appearance of expensive linen. After a mat is completed, it is given a name and used as the traditional currency of Samoa. Mats are given as gifts at weddings, funerals, the dedication of buildings, chiefly ceremonies, and other special occasions. It takes many years of work to make an exceptionally fine mat.

MAOTA O LE ALI'I or **MAOTA TOFA:** Chief's House

Matai is the Samoan word for leader or chief. There are two types of matai in Samoa - the **Ali'i** and the **Tulafale**. The Ali'i is the name of the highest title in a family. Those who hold an Ali'i title preside at council meetings, oversee proceedings, make the final important decisions (after consulting with other matai), and pass their instructions along in whispers to the High Talking Chiefs, or **Tulafale**, who are the mouthpieces of the Ali'i. They are expected to be eloquent and skilled in the art of **lauga** (oration). The Tulafale represent the Ali'i as his spokesperson. The political system of Samoa was much more open than in any other Polynesian group in the Pacific. Rather than being solely hereditary, it is possible for people to rise to chiefly status by virtue of his or her abilities, loyalty to the village, and the service one provides to the families in the village. The title of chief is conferred upon any eligible member of

the group, including women, with the common consent of the village and the chief's council. The chiefs are responsible for the general welfare of the group.

The **Maota Tofa** is the Chief's house. In Samoa, this building is usually elevated 5-8 feet signifying the Chief's prestige. A building of this size sometimes takes 3–4 months to build depending on the manpower. The master builder, called the **Tufuga**, plans and instructs all workers of the measurements of each beam and pole. He determines the fashion and the design of the sennit lashings, which hold all joints in place. The way the beams are fastened together gives support to every 6--7 feet of the roof and strengthens the roof against the strong winds and heavy rain. The large beams and the poles are cut from the native trees of Samoa. The **ifilele** (Iron wood), **koi** (Mahogany), **niu** (Coconut), **fau** (Balsom).

There are three main reasons why a chief would have a building as large and beautiful as this. (1) The chief is a well-respected individual by his family and the community and the building represents their support and goodwill. (2) His title is of a royal line, or it is the highest in the family, village or district, which he represents. (3) It represents the wealth of a strong family group or unified collection of villages.

The chief's house was simply furnished. Because finely woven mats were exchanged as currency, the more mats a chief possessed and displayed, the richer he was. They were important also as a method of paying tribute at weddings, funerals, and other public events.

Only the chief would sleep on a bed, which is made of mats stacked to a desired height. Pillows were made of bamboo and actually supported the head at the back of the neck. Samoans believe that sleeping on a hard surface will give you a strong and straight posture.

Some of the implements utilized by the chief:

- **TO'OTO'O** (or Staff). It symbolizes the authority to speak.
- **FUE** (or swish). It symbolizes the power of speech.
- **ULA FALA** (or pandanus seed lei). It symbolizes one who has been given an ordained title.
- **TANOA FAI AVA** (ava bowl). The chiefs perform a ritual ceremony of the **ava** in which a special drink is mixed in this bowl. It symbolizes peace, brotherhood and unity.
- **TAO** (or spear). It represents each chief as a warrior and shows that he is prepared and ready to fight for his family, his freedom and his village.

War clubs were favored in tribal wars because Samoans preferred hand-to-hand combat. Throwing weapons was disdained because it was considered cowardly. The clubs displayed here are carved from Hawaiian wood. Notice that the club heads are patterned after things found in nature like the pineapple and the sea urchin. Today, war clubs are finished with a coat of varnish or lacquer to preserve it and give it a shiny finish. Traditionally, they were rubbed with a cowry shell for a special gloss.

TATAU: The Art of Tatooing

Samoans have been practicing the art of tattooing for over 2000 years. Two Fijian women, Taema and Tifaiga, introduced the practice of tattooing to Samoa. Today, Samoan males desiring chiefly status or leadership roles are generally tattooed. Many other men acquire tattoos for their appeal as a mark of adulthood, a symbol of cultural identity, a revival of an ancient craft, and an acceptable body decoration of beauty.

Before the arrival of missionaries, it was compulsory for all males to be tattooed. It was considered a decorative art form, which visibly denoted rank and status. Young men were tattooed between the ages

of 14 and 18 when they had stopped growing so that the intricate designs would not stretch. Tattooing extended from the hips down to the knees. Although there has been a revival of tattooing, it still does not equal its former acceptance.

Tattooing is a painful process. The Samoan tattoo master creates the designs with a comb-like tattoo instrument. The larger the comb, the greater the area on the skin is covered with fewer strokes. He punctures the skin by tapping the instrument with a small mallet.

Samoan women were also tattooed, but usually in lesser quantity.

POLYNESIAN
CULTURAL CENTER

Aotearoa

Greeting Word: Kia Ora
Current Population: 5.1 Million

Aotearoa, located about 4,606 miles [7,412 km] from Hawaii, forms the southwest apex of the Polynesian Triangle. The country covers approximately 103,000 square miles [268,000 km²] - about the size of Japan or the U.S. state of Colorado – and consists of two major islands as well as several smaller island groups. The four-season climate turns semi tropical in the north but includes high snow covered mountains in the south.

AOTEAROA: NEW ZEALAND

"KIA ORA!" is the greeting word in New Zealand.

Legend tells us of the first explorer-navigator-discoverer of the islands. According to legend, Maui and his brothers "fished up" the islands from the sea. The North Island is "The Fish of Maui" (a stingray). The South Island is his canoe. Stewart Island is the anchor stone.

Later, in the 10th century, Kupe & Ngake (Ngahue) ventured out southwest from Tahiti, following the traditional navigational instructions left by the hero Maui so many years earlier. The instructions were simple -- they were to keep their bearings towards a certain set of stars in the sky. In their canoe, carved by their own hands, they ventured out into the unknown and reached their destination. From far off, Kupe's wife sighted land, and the gathering of white clouds around one of the mountain tops. She called out, "He ao! He ao!" (A cloud! A cloud!). Thus was Aotearoa discovered. It's Maori name means, "Long White Cloud" and is commonly referred to as "The Land of the Long White Cloud".

Polynesians have been known to set sail in search of new lands, their canoes were provisioned with food and plants for cultivation.

They remained isolated in New Zealand until the arrival of European explorers, the first of whom was the Dutchman Abel Tasman (1642). During that time, they grew in numbers to between 100,000 and 200,000, living almost exclusively on North Island. They adopted the name **Maori** to distinguish themselves from the Europeans, who after the voyages of the Englishmen Captain James Cook (1769-1777), began to come in greater frequency. Individuals, families, and extended family groups continue to acknowledge one another and are identified as descendants of specific tribal and sub-tribal ancestral leaders. These tribal leaders can trace their genealogy to the original settlers who arrived in multiple waves of migration aboard ocean-voyaging canoes.

It is situated in the South Pacific more than 1,000 miles southeast of Australia, its nearest neighbor. The country is comprised of two main islands – the North and South islands – and a number of small islands, some of them hundreds of miles from the main group. New Zealand is about 1,000 miles long and about 280 miles across at its widest point. The land area is approximately 103,000 square miles – slightly smaller than the state of Colorado and a little larger than the United Kingdom. The current population

is **5.1 million**, only about 17% of which are native Maori., making them the largest group of Polynesians in the Pacific today.

New Zealand's climate differs from one part of the country to another. The larger South Island is colder than the North Island. Exceptionally bitter winds sweep the mountain summits of both islands and there is snow in the higher altitudes. Unlike other Polynesian islands, New Zealand experiences four distinct seasons.

Within one to two days drive, one can see glaciers, fiords, snow-capped mountains, vast plains and hills, sub-tropical forests, a volcanic plateau and white-sandy beaches. The spectacular scenery of both major islands has been featured in the Hollywood films, "Lord of the Rings" & "Hobbit" trilogies, "Wolverine", "The Last Samurai" and more. Aotearoa New Zealand is one of the youngest nations, with voyaging canoes bringing the first settlers from other Polynesian islands, as late as the 12th century.

MARAE: The Courtyard

The mare is defined as a courtyard – the open area in front of a Maori meeting house and also refers to the complex of other buildings surrounding it. Formal and informal interactions between people continue to take place in such settings. They are associated with tribes and families and are located in the historical tribal regions of these groups. All Maori connect to a marae through genealogy. It's where their parents, grandparents, or ancestors are from. Through generations of intermarriage, Maori are able to connect to more than one marae.

The name of this particular marae is "Te Arohanui o Te Iwi Maori", meaning, "The Great Love of the Maori People". The name honors the Polynesian Cultural Center's founding Maori performing arts group, "Te Arohanui Maori Company which came to Hawai'i in 1963 to assist in the final preparations of the Polynesian Cultural Center's opening in October of that year.

PUHARA: Watchtower

The watchtower or **Puhara**, was built to protect the village. Puhara were manned 24-hours per day. A village was usually situated on top of a hill so that the extra height of the tower could allow a man to see for miles on all sides. If strangers were approaching, the man in the watchtower would blow a large wooden trumpet called the **pukaea** to warn the people in the village. A scout would then be sent to ascertain whether the strangers came in peace or in war. Maori protocol calls for a ceremony-of-sorts to be performed in these cases called **powhiri** in which the intent of the visitors is determined. You can see the powhiri protocol demonstrated here in this village.

PATAKA: Storage House

The storage hut was used to house heirlooms such as his jade pendants, weapons, adzes for canoe building, etc.

The Maori people ate fish, shellfish, birds, and small animals. They often salted, dried, or smoked various food items and placed them in gourds for storage. Sweet potatoes, tapioca, and the 'Maori Potato' were food staples.

They also used roofed storage pits. These are partially underground with drainage on the sides of the house. They were not only used to store food, but also to store the plants which would be used next season.

As with other Polynesians, the Maoris cooked in open-air cooking spaces, in underground ovens called a **hangi**. A pit was dug and logs were placed inside with rocks on top of the logs. As the logs burned, the rocks fell into the pit. The food was then placed on the hot rocks and covered with leaves or mats to keep the heat in for several hours, steaming the food.

Other methods used were geothermal steaming, grilling food on sticks over embers, wrapping food in clay or leaves and placing them on the embers, boiling food by placing red-hot stones in wooden bowls of liquid.

WHARE TUPUNA: Ancestral Meeting House

The **Whare Tupuna**, or the Ancestral Meeting House, is typical of those found in Maori villages in New Zealand. Such buildings are very important to the Maori people because this is where customs and ceremonies are maintained and perpetuated. In 1960, this particular building was commissioned, carved in New Zealand under the direction of Master Carver **Hone Taiapa** and shipped to Hawaii piece by piece where it was then put together for use here at the Polynesian Cultural Center.

This ancestral meeting house is named after **Hawaikiroa**, an ancient mariner who arrived in these islands (now known as Hawai'i) over 2,000 years ago, and according to legend, named them after himself.

The architecture and design of the building is full of symbolism. It represents the physical anatomy of the human body of the ancestor for whom the building is named. The apex of this building has two figures, the lower one, holding a paddle is Hawaikiroa, the common ancestor. The figure at the very top, represents his son. The facing boards on the gable of the house represent his outstretched arms, hands and fingers extended and reaching towards the ground. The ridgepole of the house represents his spine or backbone and the painted rafters, his rib cage.

Inside, the intricately carved figures on the walls represent the genealogy and family history of a tribe. Each figure or poupou depicts a specific ancestor and indicates information about him and his accomplishments. The eyes in the carvings were made from **paua** shell also known as abalone. The carvings depict tattooed faces, piercing eyes, protruding tongues and flexed leg muscles in dancing or fighting positions. These same traditional gestures are used today in dances performed in New Zealand and here at the Polynesian Cultural Center.

A person's status in the community was determined by his bloodline. Hence, it was crucial for the Maoris to memorize and recite their genealogies. These carved figures are constant reminders to the people of their ancestry. The stories, histories and genealogies of these ancestors continues to be preserved in the carvings, the oral history and music of the people. The present generation continue to bear their names.

Painted scroll ornamentations on the rafters are more than just decorative. They're called kowhaiwhai (circles within circles). They represent various foods and plants such as the sweet potato, peas, berries, and curling fern and are symbolic of nature and its importance. They tell stories of local history, symbolize aspects of the natural world and represent genealogies.

Between the carvings are the **tukutuku** panels that are woven by Maori women. Each design depicts a particular tribal historical legend that is passed from generation to generation through the weaving of these panels. The set of six panels on a stand at the end of the room tells the story of the original Maori migration to New Zealand. They are woven from the dried leaves of the **kiekie** vine, which is found abundantly throughout New Zealand. The yellow and white colors are the natural shades after drying has taken place.

KIA NGAWARI:

Kia Ngāwari houses examples of the art of Māori weaving. Weaving techniques, include finger-weaving (related to twining), ornamental lattice work, patterned strand work, braiding, weft twining and plaiting.

One of the more important varieties of native plant species found in Aotearoa New Zealand is the flax plant. The leaves can be used to craft mats, hats, bags, baskets, and even sails. The exposed inner fibers can be dyed and braided or woven into rope, fishing nets and the flax-made kilts used in the performing arts. Without the use of looms, weavers use the fibers to weave cloth, very similar to linen, which can be used as a wrap-around cloak. Many cloaks today are beautifully adorned with feathers.

KUPE:

The exhibit inside of this carved meeting house, highlights the art of Maori carving.

- Case #1 - Wood: Examples of long and short clubs made from native hardwood.
- Case #2 - Stone: Examples of Nephrite Jade, Argillite, Garnet (used as a hammer stone), Obsidian and Sandstone.
- Case #3 - Bone / Teeth / Shell: Examples of 8 shark species (found in Aotearoa New Zealand waters), abalone and whalebone.

- Case #4 - Traditional Facial Markings: Examples of a bone chisel, mallet, ink bowl, tree resin, carved mask and portraits of male and female aristocracy. This practice became outlawed in 1907.
- Case #5 - Dye: Examples of flax fibers, mordant (substance used to set dye on fibers and fabric) was made from the leaves of forest trees and shrubs, including the Celery Pine and Tea tree; forest tree bark; and iron-rich mud.

  Photos on display include Hone Taiapa, MBE, the Master Carver; Matthew Cowley, the visionary of the PCC; numerous previous employees of the marae (now deceased) and the Te Arohanui Māori Company performers.

WAKA TAUA: War Canoe

This Waka Taua or war canoe of New Zealand is one of the greatest examples of Maori carving.

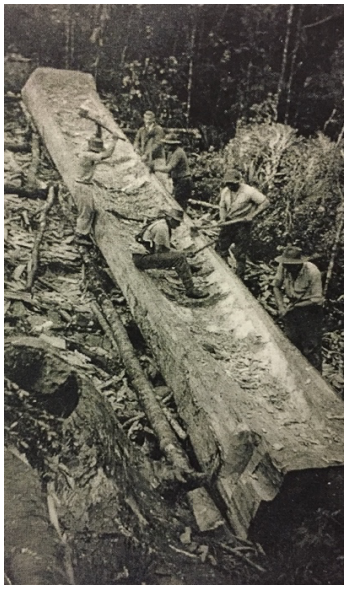
The canoe was named the 'Long Fish of Māui' (see Māui's Legend above). Traditionally, a war canoe was used as a raiding vessel along the coastlines, inland lakes and rivers. Fully manned, it could reach a speed of up to 15 miles per hour (13 knots) for short distances. In some canoes, sails were also rigged to add to the speed.

HISTORY OF THE WAKA TAUA (WAR CANOE): TE IKA-ROA-A-MĀUI - The Long Fish of Māui

On the 6th of March 1948, it was announced that King George VI (r 1936-1952) and Queen Elizabeth would embark on a Royal Tour of Australia and New Zealand the following Spring of 1949, accompanied by their daughter Princess Margaret. They would be the first reigning monarchs to visit both countries.

(National Portrait Gallery, London - 1951)

As part of the many preparations that took place for this tour to New Zealand, a giant Kauri (Agathis Australis) tree from the Puketi State Forest, Northland was felled in October of 1948.
A Waka Taua (War Canoe) was to be crafted from this tree and used as part of the welcome ceremony for the Royal Family by the Ngāpuhi people.
In addition, the canoe was to be presented as a gift to His Royal Highness.



On the 23rd of November 1948, the tour was cancelled due to the King's declining health. However, the work of construction carried on until the hull of the canoe was sufficiently completed to be transported out of the bush. The canoe was brought to rest near the Kohewhata Marae Hall, Mangakahia Rd, Kaikohe.

The idea to complete the canoe resurfaced in the early 1960's due to the Polynesian Village's Project, which was already underway in Lā'ie, Hawai'i and Tuhikaramea, Aotearoa, NZ.
Members of the Witehira, Wihongi and Tahere families are pictured here donating the hull of the canoe to the Polynesian Villages Building Committee Supervisor, John Elkington, Sr. (front left) in late 1962.

TOHUNGA WHAKAIRO (MASTER CARVERS)

Hone (John) Te Kauru Taiapa, MBE
(1912-1979)
(Ngāti-Porou)

Wiremu Piri (Bill) Te Ranga Poutapu, MBE
(1905-1975)
(Ngāti-Korokī)

Hone Taiapa was the Master Carver of the meeting house in Hawai'i, Hawaikiroa.
He called on Piri Poutapu, also a Master Carver, to oversee the completion of the canoe.
Two other experienced carvers joined the team to complete the canoe under his direction.

Tuti (Tony) Tukaokao
(1929-2001)
(Ngāti-Ranginui)

James Te Kori (Jim) Ruru
(1927-1966)
(Te Aitanga-a-Māhaki)

Tuti Tūkaokao carve rn post) an e rauawa (side boards).
Jim Ruru carved the tauihu (prow-piece).
Hēmi Whautere Witehira (1881-1965) accompanied the canoe on its' journey to Hawai'i in August of 1963. He is pictured here with Te Ika-roa-a-Māui canoe next to the lagoon at the Polynesian Villages which became known as the Polynesian Cultural Center.

Te Ika-roa-a-Māui canoe (above) resting near the marae (courtyard) with women performing the poi and men posing next to it (below).

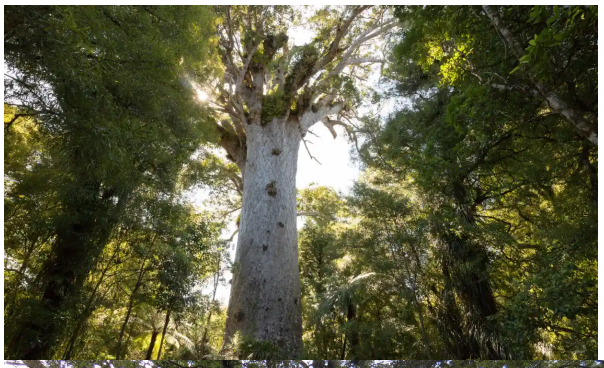
Te Ika-roa-a-Māui canoe on the lagoon with performers twirling the poi.

Te Ika-roa-a Māui war canoe at rest next to the marae (courtyard) and on the lagoon.

TREE SPECIES:

KAURI

Agathis australis, commonly known by its Māori name Kauri, is a coniferous tree of the Araucariaceae in the genus of Agathis. Kauri trees can grow to over 50 metres (160+ feet) tall and up to 7 metres (23 feet) in diameter.



TŌTARA

Podocarpus totara (tōtara) is a species of podocarp tree. Tōtara trees can grow up to 40 metres (130 feet) tall and over 6 metres (16 feet) in diameter.

Te Ika-roa-ā-Māui is 18.2 metres (60 feet) and weighs close to 2500 kgs or 2 ½ tons. This canoe carries between 34 - 40 people inclusive of the paddlers, the steersman, the leader, and a bailer.

MAORI WARRIORS:

This is a **Taiaha**. The Taiaha served as a broadsword quarterstaff, club, and spear. It is a fire-hardened wooden stave that had a long tapered, flattened shaft or blade, which broadens towards the end and has a head, nose, eyes, lips, teeth, and mouth, with a tongue-shaped spearhead on the opposite end.

The ancient Maori chiefs at ceremonial gatherings also used the taihaha. The Maori orator when making a speech emphasized his words with gestures and taiaha actions called **taki**.

The taiaha and greenstone **mere** (flat club) were both perfect weapons for close quarters combat. The advantage of a shorter club like the mere is its portability. It was usually tucked into the back waistband of the warrior's skirt and hidden from sight behind a cloak.

Weapons were often named after an ancestor.

ACTIVITIES:

Tītī-tōrea

Traditionally, this game was one of many military games played in childhood. The objective of the game was to develop and maintain effective eye-hand coordination skills, essential in future hand-to-hand combat. The game still teaches those same skills today.

It requires players to simultaneously toss sticks back and forth to each other in various patterns and in rhythm to music or chant. Players try to catch the sticks without dropping any of them and to have fun.

Long-Poi

Poi is a light ball on a string of various lengths, swung or twirled rhythmically and in unison to sung accompaniment. Traditional poi can be made from bullrush (cat's tail leaves) and attached to a flax cord or rope. Modern-day poi can be made with foam and plastic, while the handle can be plaited from yarn or cord.

Poi can be struck with either side of the hand and shoulder to create a percussive rhythm, imitate the sounds, movements and rhythms of nature. Matched with song, it can be used to enhance storytelling.

POLYNESIAN CULTURAL CENTER

Fiji

Greeting Word: Bula Vinaka
Current Population: 930,000

Fiji straddles the International Date Line about 3,100 miles [5,100 km] southwest of Hawaii. The independent tropical nation covers approximately 7,050 square miles [18,270 km²] – slightly smaller than the U.S. state of New Jersey – and includes two major islands plus about 330 smaller ones, and more than 500 islets (tiny rock formations in the ocean that are unable to sustain human habitation). The two main islands, Viti Levu & Vanua Levu, are rich in resources, including gold and copper mines.

Factoid: The Fijians were historically known as fierce warriors until soon after the paramount chief converted to Christianity in 1854.

FIJI

"BULA VINAKA" is the greeting word in Fiji.

The islands of Fiji are regarded as the **"Crossroads of the South Pacific"**, where Melanesia and Polynesia meet. Although it's geographical location defines it as part of Melanesia, the language and cultural aspects of Fiji more closely relate it to Polynesia.

Other than New Zealand, the islands of Fiji are larger than the rest of the Polynesian groups. There are a little over **330** islands, 500 islets, and there are very distinct cultural differences from island to island. Because of the great distance covered by the islands of Fiji there are a number of dialects or distinct languages spoken by the various islanders. The Fijian language is made up of approximately **20** dialects and with the multi-racial makeup of the country today, English is used as the official language. Approximately one third of the islands are inhabited.

The first Europeans to land and live among the Fijians were shipwrecked sailors and runaway convicts from the Australian penal settlements. Dutch explorer, Abel Tasman, is credited with its discovery in 1643. Major credit for recording of the islands on modern maps went to Captain William Bligh who sailed through Fiji after the mutiny on the Bounty in 1789.

Great Britain ruled over Fiji from 1874 until 1970 when Fiji became an independent dominion and removed Queen Elizabeth II as the Head of State. There were other political disturbances in 1987, 2000, and 2006 while Fiji struggled to determine its future.. The population of Fiji is today close to **930,000** (87% of which live on Viti Levu and Vanua Levu, the two main islands. Suva, the largest city and capitol, is located on Viti Levu.

About **40%** of the people are descendants of laborers brought from India almost a century ago in the indentured labor system, as contract workers for the sugar cane plantations. **50%** of the population is made up of indigenous Fijians. The remaining **10%** is a mixture of other races, including Chinese and Caucasians.

The 20th century has brought important economic and political roles for Fiji. Fiji has been productive in its sugar industry, copra milling, and tourism. Today, Fiji plays a major role in regional affairs and is recognized as a focal point of the South Pacific.

The greeting of **bula vinaka** means more than just a simple hello. It literally means "Good Health" or "Good Life". In ancient times as people entered a Fijian village area, the **lali**, or wooden drum, would ring out to announce the new arrival to the village.

BURE vs. VALE: Structures

There are two words that you will hear in Fiji referring to structures. One is **bure** and the other is **vale**. Bure denotes the style of building and also a building used irregularly but for a specific purpose. A vale denotes a structure used continually for domestic purposes, such as a family home, chief's home etc. You will notice that in most of the Bure very little furniture is found. The use of furniture began as foreigners settled and brought other ways of life to Fiji.

BURE: Family Dwelling

This structure (see photo below) is a typical **bure** or house. Because Fiji consists of many islands over a wide area, house structures differ from location to location. The structures found here at the Polynesian Cultural Center are patterned after structures found in the **Lau** group of the islands of Fiji.

The Bure is constructed with layered reed walls lashed together with sennit. As in all Fijian structures, tapa cloth, or **masi** as it is called in Fiji, is dominant as decoration. The colors of Fijian masi are usually darker than in other Polynesian cultures. In ancient times, masi had specific patterns that indicated the area a designer came from. They often had genealogical significance for a family.

The roof is covered with a sugarcane leaf thatching. To keep the thatching free of insects or animals that would feed on the leaves, a fire is often built inside the building. The smoke rises into the thatching, forcing most animal life out of the leaves, similar to today's fumigation methods. Fijian structures are usually constructed with very high-pitched roofs that allow for better air circulation inside and for the frequent Fijian rain to easily run off on the outside. The roofs have a life expectancy of ten to fifteen years depending upon the craftsmanship.

This is what a typical village of bure would have looked like back in Fiji. (See image.)

VALE LEVU: Chief's House

A traditional Fijian village includes the chief's house, the largest structure and most elevated building, unless that village had a **Bure Kalou** (see 'Bure Kalou' section). The Chief's house's stature was further marked with white cowry shells, which you can observe hanging on the doors and at various locations, both inside and outside the house.

The front door in the east is the entryway for commoners and servants. The two side doors, facing north and south, are entryways for the chief's wife and family and visiting dignitaries. The back door, always facing the west, is reserved only for the chief himself. Anciently, armed warriors stood guard at the chief's door, and any person other than the chief who entered through it was put to death. Today, the custom is still practiced, only without the warrior guards posted to enforce the protocol of tradition, since it is a given that Fijians should know the correct door through which to enter.

The chief's bed is made of piled-up pandanus mats topped with **tapa** cloth. Frequently, a bamboo frame was utilized, again filled with layers of mats to ensure softness. The floor would have a layer of sand, covered with layers of dried leaves and soft branches, upon which would be piled layers of mats.

The headrest seen on the bed is a typical Fijian pillow to keep the head elevated above the body. This was necessary because the head was believed to be the location of the power of an individual. On a more practical level, the luxurious Fijian "hair do" necessitated that shape of headrest. The lower bed is for the chief's wife and children. If the chief practiced polygamy, the favored wife and her children slept there. The other wives were sometimes provided sleeping quarters. At the opposite end of the building, the chief would receive his guests and entertain them.

VALE NI BOSE: Meeting House

The **Vale Ni Bose** serves many purposes as it is used for ceremonial, official and private functions. Ceremonial uses include the welcoming of village chiefs, discussing of official matters and the holding of **yaqona** or **kava** ceremonies. During these meetings, women and children are forbidden in the building. The yaqona or kava is a ceremonial drink that was served at these meetings. The root of the kava, a plant of the pepper family, is dried and pounded into a powder, which is then mixed with water. This drink is found in most cultures of the Pacific. As late as the 19th century, young maidens prepared and served the kava to the elders of the village.

Women and children sometimes use this building as an arts and crafts center. The major art forms of Fiji are weaving, carving and pottery making. Using the leaves of the pandanus plant does most weaving. The thinner and closer the weaving, the more valuable the product was. Items woven include mats, baskets, fans, etc. The making of pottery in Fiji is a Melanesian influence dating back earlier than 1300 B.C. Pottery making was apparently known and practiced in Samoa and Tonga originally but was abandoned due to their lack of clay. Archaeologists have discovered bits of pottery as far east as the Marquesas.

Lali or drums were used for long distance communication. Through various rhythms a message could be sent. Today a lali is used much like a bell to call people to meetings or in time of emergency. In ancient times the lali was used during funerals and was beaten continuously, night and day, until the funeral ended. Smaller lali are used to accompany singing and dancing. Another form of communication favored by the Fijian people is the conch shell. After a hole is cut in the side of the shell, it is played much like a horn. Fishermen would blow it when returning to the village, indicating a good catch.

DERUA: Bamboo Percussion Activity

Ancient and modern Fijian people used the **DERUA** or bamboo log, to provide rhythm as accompaniment to music and dance. Holding a bamboo stick in each hand with the blocked end down, the various lengths were pounded on the ground to create pitch and rhythm. With each hit, the air within the hollow tube resonates, which results in a distinctive **DERUA** sound. The exact pitch or tone is based upon the length of the bamboo and not the diameter. It has been found that **DERUA** can be tuned in series with every 1/4 inch equaling a quartertone. The **DERUA** was a natural instrument in Fiji. Bamboo grows hollow with a block at each joint. Lengths of bamboo were cut just below a joint and all other blocks in the length were removed except the bottom one. All villagers could join in the fun and festivity by pounding the **DERUA**.

BURE KALOU: Fijian Temple

The **Bure Kalou** or spirit house was usually built on the highest mound in a village, even higher than the chief's house. Strings of **buli vulavula**, or white cowry shells, hung from the **lore** or the two fern stumps at the end of the highest point of the roof. The white cowry always indicated the highest form of respect. In the bure kalou, the village **bete**, or priest, would sit inside at the bottom of a long strip of **masi**, or white **tapa** hung from the ceiling of the structure. He was the only person allowed inside the spirit house. The priest was thought to be conversing with the ancestral god, through the long strip of masi. It was thought that in order to be successful in battle or leadership, the chief had to take food offerings and sacrifices to the bure kalou regularly and consult with the **bete**.

Image: Bure Kalou in Fiji. Photo by David Fleetham.

VALE NI KURO: Cooking Structure

The Fijian underground oven is called **LOVO**, which is basically a pit dug in the ground in which wood and stones are placed for a fire. In other parts of Polynesia, it is known as an **IMU** or **UMU**. When the wood burns down and the stones reach a high temperature, the food, which has been wrapped in leaves to prevent scorching, is placed in the **lovo**. Ti leaves, breadfruit and banana leaves are most often used. More leaves are used to cover the wrapped food. The complete **lovo** is then covered with earth to seal the steam, which cooks and flavors the food.

Fijian people eat many various fruits and vegetables, including breadfruit, sweet potatoes, bananas, tapioca, taro, and papaya. Fijians are also excellent fishermen and so their diet includes all forms of fish, shellfish, and other edible sea life. Wild pigs and chickens are plentiful throughout the islands of Fiji. When the first migrants arrived in the Pacific, they brought with them the pig and the dog from Asia. Other livestock such as cattle and horses were not introduced until as late as the 15th & 16th centuries.

COPRA:

The coconut is the most versatile and useful of all Polynesian plants. Copra is the dried flesh of the coconut and used to be one of Fiji's major exports before it was surpassed by sugar cane production. To make copra, a coconut is opened and the flesh is left in the sun to dry. From the dried coconut, the rich oil is extracted. Both the fresh and dried flesh of the coconut is used in various ways. The coconut flesh can be grated into coconut oil and then used for candles, cosmetics, and soap or in cooking. The list of ingredients of many commercial products including prepared foods and cosmetics includes the use of the coconut as one of the main ingredients.

The fibers of the husk are braided to make *sennit* cord used to lash all buildings together. A common use of husk fibers is as a scrubber for kitchen utensils and the body. The Fijians also hollowed out the coconut shells for drinking cups, soap dishes, water bottles and containers plus a myriad of other uses. When charcoal is needed, they burn coconut shells. Coconut milk is put in an airtight container to which flower petals and fragrant leaves are added. The container is left in the sun for several days. New petals and leaves are added daily until the coconut oil is clarified and ready to use as moisturizing lotion or soap.

CAMAKAU: Fijian Canoe

Canoes played an important role in the lives of the Fijians; they were used for social purposes, economic reasons (trade) and for the most part political purposes. In times of war, canoes such as this were used in sea battles for ramming enemy canoes as well as transporting warriors to sites of land battle. Superior canoes conferred political advantage to an island, which resulted in both protection, and the ability to conquer other islands.

This is a Fijian Camakau (tha-ma-kau) or, a Fijian outrigger canoe. The Fijians are considered as some of the finest canoe builders in the South Pacific. This particular canoe was constructed on an island east of the main Fijian island group, known as KABARA. The men on this island were born craftsmen who were very skilled canoe builders. In Fiji there are four classes of canoes:

1) **"Drua**" which is a double hulled canoe, and the largest class of canoes.
2) **"Takia"** which is a smaller outrigger canoe with a dugout hull.
3) **"Camakau"** which is a larger outrigger canoe with a covered hull
4) **"Tabilai"** a war canoe with thick ends used for ramming.

This particular canoe was built in 1985 and completed in just two months. After all the required rituals and tests, this canoe was shipped to Hawaii by the then Prime Minister of Fiji, **Ratu Sir Kamisese Mara**, who is considered by many to be the Founding Father of the modern-day Fiji. The island of **Kabara** where this canoe was built is part of the **Lau** group.

This **camakau** was built using both modern and traditional tools. The tree was felled in the forest and then moved to a convenient place, not too close to the village, where it was built. This historical event was recorded and documented for the nearby Brigham Young University – Hawaii. It was presented to PCC and BYU-Hawaii to be an educational tool for Pacific Island Studies majors.

One of the most unique features of a **camakau** is its ability to change direction without taking time to turn around. By merely adjusting the position of the sail, a **camakau** can go in the opposite direction without having to turn around like other sailing vessels. Canoes like this normally travel at speeds up to 8 – 9 miles per hour, but are capable of even greater speeds.

More than 30 different plant species were used in the construction of this canoe. For example, this canoe was built from a single 40 foot **VESI** LOG, or HEARTWOOD. The outrigger is made out of **NOKONOKO** (Ironwood). Typically, the **CAMA** (Tha-ma - outrigger) would be made from **UTO** (breadfruit tree). It is all lashed together with the **MAGIMAGI** or sennit rope braided from fibers of the coconut husk.

The owner of a **camakau** was usually a chief, a village or an extended family due to the expenses involved in owning a canoe, such as the many feast and presentations associated with the construction of such a canoe.

FIJIAN WEAPONS:

A little over a hundred years ago, the Fijians were using many types of clubs. Apart from the **gadi**, a small ornamental club carried by correctly dressed warriors and chiefs at peacetime ceremonial occasions, all clubs were used for war. They were therefore made of the hardest woods, such as ironwood or ***vesi***. Many had fine linear carving on their handles, designed by the individual warrior who made and used the club.

The **Iula** were throwing clubs with short handles and bulbous heads. These were the most deadly Fijian clubs capable of competing with revolvers in close situations. If the handle struck the victim first it could penetrate the flesh, the heavy head jack-knifing onto the victim even if the handle did not pierce him, thus dealing a crippling, if not finishing blow.

The **cai** or **qata**, the spurred or "gun stock" clubs (*so-called because of their resemblance in appearance to rifle butts or stocks*), are designed for cutting and disjointing blows. That of a rifle did not inspire their shape although they look similar to one, but rather by the shape of the *"bird of paradise"* flower.
The **waka** or the root club had straight handles with a natural knot of roots at the end and were used to crush skulls easily.

POLYNESIAN
CULTURAL CENTER

Hawai'i

Greeting Word: Aloha
Current Population: 1.3 million

Hawai'i, at the northern apex of the Polynesian Triangle and the only major part of Polynesia above the equator, is located approximately 2,500 miles [4,000 km] west south west of the US Mainland. Eight major islands (seven inhabited) and over 100 smaller ones cover approximately 6,400 square miles [16,600 km².] The climate ranges from tropical rainforests to high volcanic peaks covered in winter snow.

Factoid: Some modern Hawaiians are striving to re-establish a recognized form of sovereignty, perhaps similar to Native American Nations in other parts of the U.S.

HAWAII

"ALOHA!" is the greeting word for Hawaii.

The Hawaiian greeting of **ALOHA** is probably the most well known Polynesian word. Of the more than twenty islands in the Hawaiian group, only seven are inhabited. Hawaii spreads over a distance of about **400** miles. The eight main islands (seven of which are inhabited) are volcanic islands while the others are small coral islands. Together, they comprise about **6,424** square miles of land. The population of approximately **1.3million** (80% of which live on Oahu) is composed of a mixture of Polynesians, Asians, and Caucasians.

Hawaii has a mild, tropical climate with seasonal temperature fluctuations of only about 10 degrees. The islands are exposed to yearly Northeast trade winds. More rain falls on the island of Kauai than on any other spot on earth. The first Hawaiians migrated from the Marquesas Islands approximately 30-40 generations ago settling first on Kauai and Oahu. A late migration from Tahiti settled on Hawaii and Maui. Many have tried to discover when the migrations took place, but no one knows the exact date. Communication between Hawaii and Tahiti remained active.

After an initial discovery by the Spaniard Gaetano, the Hawaiian Islands were rediscovered by Captain James Cook in 1778. Captain Cook named the discovery the "Sandwich Islands" after his patron, the Earl of Sandwich. **King Kamehameha I** united the islands into an independent kingdom in 1796. This period of royal rule stretched until 1893 when Queen Liliuokalani's monarchy was overthrown and Hawaii was annexed by the United States of America in 1898. Later, in 1959, the Hawaiian Islands were officially named the "Aloha State" when they officially joined the U.S. as its fiftieth state. Since gaining statehood, Hawaii's economy has evolved from one dependent on sugarcane and pineapple crops to a profitable economy based on tourism. It is Hawaii's largest source of revenue.

The official State bird is the Nene, or Hawaiian Goose, which is native to Hawaii and protected as an endangered species. Prior to 1778 (when Capt. James Cook arrived) there were about 25,000 Nene. By the mid 1900's, wild Nene numbered less than 30. Breeding programs at Slimbridge in England and Pohakuloa, Hawaii have helped bring the current population in Hawaii up to about 3,000 birds.

The State Tree of Hawaii is the Candlenut or **kukui**, whose nut is rich with natural oils. The nuts of this tree provided the ancient Hawaiians with light, oil, relishes, and medicine. The kernels are strung together with coconut mid-ribs and lit to be used as candles. Each kernel has enough oil in it to burn for approximately eight minutes. Because of it's rich content, it was also used as a laxative. The oil was also used to partially waterproof canoes and small water craft.

BASIC INFORMATION ABOUT THE VILLAGE:

This village is patterned after a typical Hawaiian family compound from around 1750 A.D. Each family had a single-room hut which was used mostly for sleeping. In ancient Hawaii, each household consisted of a number of separate, but associated huts that together comprised what was called the **'kauhale'** (dwellings). Thus, each household could have several houses in one area, as well as a different cluster in another area, and the 'kauhale' were frequently separated by some distance.

Further, there were specific functions assigned to various houses in each cluster, with certain dwellings designated as sleeping huts, others for eating (men ate separately from the women and children, for their eating hut was regarded as a religiously significant place in which food offerings were made to the gods and ancestors), and cooking huts that consisted of stone walled areas with thatched roofs for food preparation. There were other huts within the kauhale that were task specific as well, such as those for canoe makers and others used to house fishing gear. These buildings belonged to the entire village, and not to one particular family.

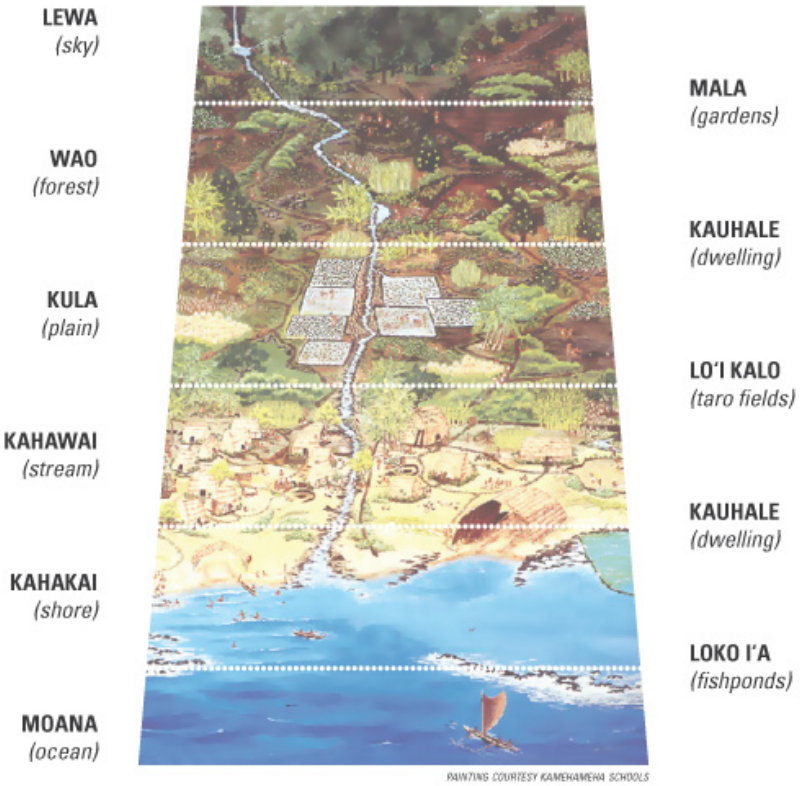
Hawaiian structures are covered with **pili** grass, which is found on higher altitudes. The grass is bundled and layered on the cross beams and frames of the buildings. Pili grass contains a natural

waxy substance that causes it to stick together when wet. This provides an ideal waterproof covering for the buildings. This 'sticking together' is called **pili** in Hawaiian. When the leaves dry out, they separate again, allowing for air circulation within the buildings.

The inside of the buildings are lined with **lauhala**, or pandanas leaves. This leaf is very universal in Polynesia and is used by the islands people for weaving. Enclosed buildings typically did not have windows or additional doors, and normally the doors were low and one had to bend down or crawl to enter, however, for our guests' convenience and ease of access, you will find normal doors and windows on the structures here.

AHUPUA'A:

The concept of private property was unknown to ancient Hawaiians, but they did follow a complex system of land division. All land was controlled ultimately by the highest chief or king who held it in trust for the whole population. A whole island, or **mokupuni**, was divided in smaller parts, down to a basic unit belonging to a single family.



PAINTING COURTESY KAMEHAMEHA SCHOOLS

Each **mokupuni** was divided into several **moku**, the largest units within each island, usually wedge-shaped and running from the mountain crest to shore. O`ahu was divided into six moku.

Each moku was divided into **ahupua`a**, narrower wedge-shaped land sections that again ran from the mountains to the sea. The size of the ahupua`a depended on the resources of the area with poorer agricultural regions split into larger ahupua`a to compensate for the relative lack of natural abundance. Each ahupua`a was ruled by an ali`i or local chief and administered by a **konohiki**.
Each ahupua`a contained the resources the human community needed, from fish and salt, to fertile land for farming taro or sweet potato, to koa and other trees growing in upslope areas. Villagers from the coast traded fish for other foods or for wood to build canoes and houses. Specialized knowledge and resources peculiar to a small area were also shared among ahupua`a.

Although there was no private ownership of property, land tenure of the **maka`ainana** (commoners) was stable. They paid weekly labor taxes and annual taxes to the konohiki, or local overseer, who collected goods to support the chief and his court. The konohiki supervised communal labor within the ahupua`a and also regulated land, water and ocean use.

Stewardship of the land and its resources was formalized through the **kapu** system. The kapu (taboo) - administered and enforced by konohiki and kahuna, or priests - placed restrictions on fishing certain species during specific seasons, on gathering and replacing certain plants, and on many aspects of social interaction as well. In this way, the community maintained a sustainable lifestyle. Through sharing resources and constantly working within the rhythms of their natural environment, Hawaiians enjoyed abundance and a quality lifestyle with leisure time for recreation during the harvest season of the year. This lifestyle also encouraged a high level of artistic achievement. Many crafts, including Hawaiian kapa and featherwork, were the finest in the Pacific. Hawaiians devoted themselves to competitive sport and martial arts as well as expression through dance and chant, creating rich traditions that continue today.

HALAU HO'IKE: Presentation House

A halau was a very important house in Hawaii. Within buildings like this, much of the culture, history and heritage passed from one generation to the next. Knowledge was passed orally through stories, chants and dances in special buildings such as this. It is a place of learning and growth.

HALE MUA: Men's Eating House

In ancient Hawaii their religious beliefs and practices did not permit the family the opportunity to eat together. The women of the family had their own eating-house called **Hale 'Aina**. All children would eat with their mother in the women's eating-house until the young boy turned 8, 9 or 10. The age varied in different areas. At that time he would move to the **Hale Mua** and learn the ways of men.

The **Hale Mua** was the socio-cultural institution for religious services, political matters concerning the community, and perpetuation of traditional cultural practices and beliefs. This included customary rituals associated with boys growing into productive, contributing men in society. It implies teaching gender roles and responsibilities, customs, life skills, proper behavior and conduct, and guidance and support of spiritual growth. It's where Hawaiian men earned the roles and responsibilities of being a successful father, husband, and warrior, and basic occupations like farming and fishing. Elders and master practioners served as educators. This emphasized moral character development and adherence to **kapu** governing forbidden or inappropriate behavior. The education received in the **Hale Mua** also encouraged the preservation and maintenance of **mana** or power. By sustaining one's **mana** each man fulfilled his **kuleana** or responsibilities by honoring his **kupuna** or elders.

This type of societal rule called **kapu**, also prevented women from eating certain foods like bananas, coconuts and specific types of fish. It was followed until the year after Kamehameha's death, when Liholiho (Kamehameha II) ate together with his mother, Ka'ahumanu, abolishing the kapu.

The **la'amia** (or calabash) is an evergreen tree that grows to around 25 ft in height that produces large, thin-shelled waxy, green, spherical gourd, up to 20 inches in diameter. This gourd is called **ipu** and is dried out, hollowed and used as a bowl. **La'i** or ti leaves are used like tin foil wrapping when doing barbeques. They store the cooked food in the leaf or wrap the raw foods in the leaf and cook it. Various woods were used as bowls and trays.

In the corner of the building there are **ki'i** or handcarved wooden images representing Hawaiian dieties.

Image: Queen Ka'ahumanu, wife of Kamehameha the Great, mother of Liholiho (Kamehameha II).

HALE NOHO or **HALE NOA:** Family Dwelling

Of all the buildings used by the Hawaiian family, the hale **noho** had the least restrictions. In this building the family could meet and share thoughts. The building was also used by the family as a sleeping house. Because they lived with extended family and everyone slept together, there were assigned area for sleeping. Children slept on the outer ends of the hales, and adult males slept closest to the doors to protect their families in case of attack.

Beds were very simple. Pili grass and dried leaves were spread on the pebbled or sandy floors for cushioning. Mats were often placed over the grass to serve as beds. During the day, they were put out in the sun to cleanse and refresh them, then brought back in for use during the night.

HALE HANA: Work House or Workshop

The Hale Hana could be used for many different purposes. Hana means 'to work', so this is a workshop used to make or do many different things, depending on what was needed for the village.

HALE ULANA: Weaving Hut

Weaving is done primarily with **lauhala** or Pandanas leaves. The pandanus tree has a fruit that resembles, and is sometimes mistaken by visitors, for pineapple. The fruit on the tree is called **puhala**, and when it ripens turns a bright red, yellow or orange depending on the variety of the tree. It is often used for making leis. The fruit is made up of smaller sections that when united makes the ball you see on the tree. These sections in ancient times, when ripe, were chewed on by the Hawaiian children and used as a type of candy. One can also take these dried sections and peel them open for meat on the inside that are like pine nuts. The skin is so tough, that adults used this only during times of famine when there was nothing else available.

The leaves are picked and dried. Then the thorns down the sides and back are removed, the leaf is cleaned, flattened, and stored in rolls called **poka'a**. When they need to weave they strip the leaves to the appropriate size and commence making the items desired.

HALE ALI'I: Chief's Council House

The Hale Ali'i represents the house of the **ali'i** or chief. It was built on the most prominent rise in the area and was often further elevated by a stone platform. Besides establishing the owner's elevated social status, this architectural style also protected the house from floods. The exterior thatching is of pili grass, which was sometimes then covered with large fishing nets to keep the grass from curling and looking untidy. The roof in the interior was usually thatched with pandanus leaves, and mats covered the floor. The Hale Ali'i was primarily a place for the chief to sleep, rest or confer with other leaders. In ancient times the Hale Ali'i was forbidden to women and children.

All the items in this building are items related to the rule of the Chief. In ancient time feathers were like diamonds to the Hawaiians. They were set aside and used to adorn people of nobility. Symbolic of the chief's prestige, the Hale Ali'i often had kahili displayed on the outside or the inside. These kahili, or royal insignia, were made of feathers owned only by the Ali'i and are comparable to flags or banners carried for the royal courts in Europe. The kahili always preceded the Ali'i to alert the people to bow low as he approached as a token of respect. Similarly, the priests, or kahuna, would often precede the Ali'i carrying the taboo staff, called **pulo'ulo'u** (a stick covered with a ball of white tapa material at the top), which was intended to ward off evil spirits. This was used like a no trespassing sign. If the chief wanted an area to remain private for his use, one would see this staff pegged in the area. If the chief was in residence and did not want to be disturbed, you would see one outside the door.

The **Ali'i**, or High Chief, wore an **ahu'ula** or feathered cape. Many feathers they used were around the size of a fingernail, so it took thousands of feathers for the making of these capes. There are two distinguishing facts about these capes, the first being it's size. The longer the cape, the higher the rank of that chief. Also, the yellow or gold feathers of the birds were the most rare, so the more gold or yellow on the cape, the higher the rank of that particular chief.

The **lei niho pala'oa** was worn by both men and women and was crafted from braided human hair and highlighted with a pendant carved from a whale's tooth in the shape of a curving tongue.

The feathered crown or helmet is called the **mahi'ole**. There are two stories as to the shape of the helmet; one speaks of the rainbow – a sign from the heaven. The other tells the story about the crest of the rooster – a sign of authority. The helmet is made from the rootlets of the vine known as the '**ie'ie** which works like rattan or wicker. After the frame is completed feathers may be added to it.

Other items used by the **mo'i wahine**, or lady in waiting, included the crown, or **lei hulu**, made from feathers bound into a circlet for the hair or the neck, and finely woven lauhala fans and delicate feather kahili with decorated handles.

HALE LAWAI'A: Fisherman's Store House

This building was used by the fishermen to store items such as fish net, crab nets, weights, cordage, and bamboo needed for making nets and other such items used by fishermen. It was usually located close to the seashore, where fishermen could mend their nets and access their fishing gear. Nets and lines like this were made of olona vines or coconut husk fibers and were valued possessions. Fish hooks were made out of tortoise and oyster shells, and pig, dog, or even human bones. Certain hardwoods or lava rock was used to shape the hooks.

HALE NO'EAU: House of Games of Skill

This is another house of learning and holds games used by Hawaiians to develop physical and mental skills needed for daily life.

HU: Hawaiian Spinning Tops

The **kukui** kernel is used for the making of tops such as these. This objective is to keep as many tops spinning at the same time as possible.

KONANE: Hawaiian Checkers

In Hawaiian checkers every time you move you must jump over your opponent. The board is a set up alternating dark and white pebbles. To start the game place a pebble in each hand, place your hands behind your back and rotate the pebbles until satisfied. Bring hands to the front and your opponent selects a hand. The white pebble jumps first so with the 4 spaces available in the middle of the board the game starts rotating turns always jumping over and opponents pebble. One can double or triple jump but only in the same direction. There are no diagonal moves, one can only move up and down or from across.

ULUMAIKA: Lawn bowling

The original disks were made from stone. The objective is to roll the disks through the two pegs at the end of the lane.

PALA'IE: Loop and Ball

It's a game taught to the children by the mothers. They taught the game, using a story.

The ball represents a young bird learning how to fly. The loop represents the nest. That's why the ball starts on the top of the loop. Any bird learning how to fly, doesn't fly far from the nest before returning home. So, the ball starts on the top of the loop and swings towards you, swinging down it touches the bottom of the loop and then swings back and lands on the loop (nest) in one swing. Once that is achieved, it is used to keep a rhythm back and forth from top to bottom and back. This game is used to teach basic hand and eye coordination to the children so that they had some basic motor skills. All cultures have their own games to teach hand and eye coordination. This Palaʻie game, is one of those games for Hawaiʻi. There is also a chant sung when playing the game.

E kau, e kau, e io ē E kiʻi i wai no kāua I hea ka wai e kiʻi ai I uka wale o Ninole

Tips: First, you will notice that the string is the right length for the loop, and if you swing the ball fast enough that the sting is taught going down and back up, the ball will never go too far or too short of the loop, so you don't have to chase the ball. Remember that you are holding the game in your hand and every time your hand moves the game moves too.

Secondly, if the ball is hitting your hand or arm on the way up or down, it is probably because the game is pointing in the same line as your arm. Turn the game outward so that the ball swings away from both your arm and hand, then tuck your fingers in so that they don't interfere with the swing. When you throw the ball, throw it straight up. If you are throwing it to the side, the ball will go to the side of the loop.

Lastly, when the ball comes back to the top, give it a softer landing by moving with the ball so that it doesn't bounce out. Don't be too ridged that the ball won't sit in the loop.

**Let the guests try to figure out the game a little before helping them. If you tell them how to figure it out from the start, they won't learn anything. Let them work for it for a bit and then give them the tips on how to play. They will feel more accomplished if they can figure out the problem themselves.

HU: Hawaiian Spinning Kukui Tops

This game is called Hū and they are Kukui nut tops. In this game, the object is to have all 5 tops spinning on the wooden plater at the same time by yourself. You can use both hands to spin the tops or hold them all in one hand and use the other to spin them individually. However you do it, they all need to be spinning at the same time by yourself. This game taught fine finger dexterity and fine motor skills to the children. This game also teaches observation.

Tips: You will notice that some tops spin better than others, so observation is key. The worst top should go last because you don't need it to be spinning for a long time. The order that you spin the tops is important as well as how fast you can put them down. You may notice that the top doesn't move around as much if you place the top on the board to spin it rather than dropping it on to the board to spin. Also, some top don't move as much if they are not spun the fastest.

ULUMAIKA: Rolling Disks
Ulumaika is sometimes call Hawaiian Bowling, however nothing is knocked over. It is a game used to train the larger motor skills of hand and eye coordination.

The object of the game is to roll the disc between the two sticks. The playing surface is not smooth and flat, so you need to adjust to the terrain as you roll the disc. To play this game, it is better if there are two contestants, one on either side of the stick so you can roll the disc back and forth. Otherwise, someone has to walk to the other side to retrieve the disc. Because we are in a small playing area, please do not roll the disc too hard, or it might injure someone on the other side.

Like with bowling you want to step forward with the opposite foot of the hand that you are rolling the disc. Holding the disc underhanded will help the disc roll in the right direction. The first person on either side to roll the disc between the sticks 3 times wins.

HULA:
Hula today is commonly divided into two broad categories. Ancient hula, as performed before Western encounters with Hawaii, is called **kahiko**. It is accompanied by chant and traditional instruments. Hula as it evolved under Western influence, in the 19th and 20th centuries, is called **ʻauana**. It is accompanied by song and Western-influenced musical instruments such as the guitar, the ukulele, and the double bass.

Hula is taught in schools called **hālau**. The teacher of hula is the **kumu hula**, where **kumu** means source of knowledge. Hula dancing is a complex art form, and there are many hand motions used to signify aspects of nature. The hand motions in hula are the focus, and different motions have different meanings. They tell the story of the accompanying **mele**, or chant, and are meant to help convey the feelings and emotions of the performers.

Hula kahiko encompassed an enormous variety of styles and moods, from the solemn and sacred to the frivolous. Many hula were created to praise the chiefs and performed in their honor, or in honor of the gods.

This type of hula was considered a religious performance, rather than entertainment, which is why you will notice that the dancers do not smile while they perform. As was true of ceremonies at the **heʻiau** (temple), even a minor error was considered to invalidate the performance. It might even be a presage of bad luck or have dire consequences. Dancers who were learning to do such hula necessarily made many mistakes. Hence they were ritually secluded and put under the protection of the goddess **Laka** during the learning period. Ceremonies marked the successful learning of the hula and the emergence from seclusion.

Hula kahiko is performed today by dancing to the historical chants. They are accompanied by chanting and the beating of the **ipu heke**, or gourd drum and performed with a reverence for their spiritual roots.

Hawaiian history was oral history. It was codified in genealogies and chants, which were memorized strictly as passed down. In the absence of a written language, this was the only available method of ensuring accuracy. Chants told the stories of creation, mythology, royalty, and other significant events and people.

Hula ‘auana, or modern-style hula, arose from adaptation of traditional hula ideas (dance and mele) to Western influences. The primary influences were Christian morality and melodic harmony. Hula ‘auana still tells or comments on a story, but the stories may include events since the 1800s and are more of an entertaining nature. The music is heavily Western-influenced, and usually includes the accompaniment of less traditional instruments, like the guitar, steel guitar and ukulele.

There are two songs that are sung as guests learn the hula ‘auana in the Hawaiian village:

I Don’t Like Shoes

I don’t like shoes upon my feet
To be at ease is such a treat and
I smile at everyone I meet;
That’s the Hawaiian in me.

Along the Beach

Along the beach at Waikiki
A fair wahine is waiting for me,
With nice eyes and lovable charms
And a sweet Hawaiian hospitality.

LO’I KALO: Taro patch or pond

Lo‘i kalo are ponds for wetland *kalo* that are enclosed by banks of earth. They are constructed near *kahawai* (streams) because they are irrigated with stream water. The *Hawaiians* used a system that allowed water from the stream to run through an *‘auwai*(ditch) into the uppermost *lo‘i kalo* and flow through the openings in the terraces to each lower *lo‘i kalo*. The water is eventually discharged back into the stream. Many steps went into making a *lo‘i kalo*.

LOKO I’A: Fish Pond

Ancient Hawaiians had the most advanced fish husbandry system of the different island-nations of the Pacific. They built fishponds along the shores and water inlets. They created rock walls that allowed seawater to ebb and flow into the ponds. Gates built into the wall, would help circulate the water, and also allow small fish into the pond. Once the fish were in, they would eat the algae and other foods provided by the villagers. As they became larger, the fish would no longer be able to leave the pond through the gates, becoming trapped inside. In this way, Hawaiians were always able to maintain a readily available fish supply, which is important, since fish was their main form of protein.

Name	Portrait	Birth
Kamehameha I Spring, 1795 – May 8, 1819 ***First King over all of the newly united Hawaiian islands**		c. 1758 Moʻokini Heiau, Kohala, Hawaiʻi island son of Keōua and Kekuʻiapoiwa
Kamehameha II May 20, 1819 – July 14, 1824 ***Son of Kamehameha I**		November 1797 Hilo, Hawaiʻi island son of Kamehameha I and Keōpūolani
Kamehameha III June 6, 1825 – December 15, 1854 ***Son of Kamehameha I** **Brother of Kamehameha II**		August 11, 1813 Keauhou Bay, North Kona, Hawaiʻi island son of Kamehameha I and Keōpūolani
Kamehameha IV January 11, 1855 – November 30, 1863 ***Hanai son of Kamehameha III**		February 9, 1834 Honolulu, Oʻahu biological son of Kekūanāoʻa and Kīnaʻu and hānai son of Kamehameha III and Kalama
Kamehameha V November 30, 1863 – December 11, 1872 ***Brother of Kamehameha IV**		December 11, 1830 Honolulu, Oʻahu biological son of Kekūanāoʻa and Kīnaʻu and hānai son of Nāhiʻenaʻena (later) Hoapili and Kaheiheimālie

Lunalilo January 8, 1873 – February 3, 1874 ***Cousin of Kamehameha V** **Grand-nephew of Kamehameha I** **First King elected by Legislature**			January 31, 1835 Pohukaina, Honolulu, Oʻahu son of Kanaʻina and Kekāuluohi
Kalākaua February 12, 1874 – January 20, 1891 ***Elected King by Legislature**			November 16, 1836 Honolulu, Oʻahu biological son of Kapaʻakea and Keohokālole and hānai son of Kinimaka and Haʻaheo Kaniu
Liliʻuokalani January 29, 1891 – January 17, 1893 ***Sister of Kalākaua**			September 2, 1838 Honolulu, Oʻahu biological daughter of Kapaʻakea and Keohokālole and hānai daughter of Pākī and Kōnia

POLYNESIAN MIGRATIONS

The Pacific Ocean is the largest ocean in the world. It covers approximately one third of the surface area of the entire globe. If we were to put all the world's continents into it there would still be enough room to fit another continent the size of Asia in.

Within the Pacific there are basically three groups of island people that live there—the Polynesians, the Micronesians, and the Melanesians. When the Europeans came into the Pacific they selected the names of these area based on some aspect of that particular place.

Micro means "small" and **nesia,** comes from the Greek word meaning "islands" so **Micronesia** means "small or tiny islands." Most of the islands in this group are tiny coral atolls where the highest point above sea level is about 15 feet. They can be very small measuring about 2 miles wide by 3 miles long. The people that live here are believed to have come from the Philippines about 11,000 years ago. The "**mela**" in Melanesia means black or dark—so these are sometimes called the "dark (or black) islands." The people that live here are darker in skin color than the other Pacific island people. The Melanesians are believed to have migrated here about 20,000 years ago from either Australia (the aborigines) or came across land bridges from Africa when the water levels were much lower. "**Poly**" in Polynesia means "many" – in other words this area was known as "many islands." There are over 25,000 islands in this area. The people of Polynesia are believed to have arrived in this area between 2000 to 3000 years ago.

If you extend an imaginary line from Hawaii in the north to New Zealand in the south and then over to Easter Island and then back up to Hawaii you will see what we call the Polynesian Triangle. Most of the islands, which are inhabited by the Polynesians, are found within this imaginary triangle. It covers an area of about 16 million square miles—most of that water. You see Fiji is on the border between Melanesia and Polynesia. Though the Melanesians originally settled Fiji, when the Polynesians moved in they took over large parts of Fiji and had a profound influence on the culture. Fijians adopted many aspects of Polynesian culture and today considers itself part of Polynesia.

Where the Polynesians came from is somewhat of a controversial question. Most anthropologists will tell you that they came from Southeast Asia and there is evidence to support this theory. For example, many of the staple foods eaten throughout Polynesia including the taro, tapioca, breadfruit, and banana come from that part of the world. The domesticated animals they brought—the pigs, chickens, and dogs – are also from the Southeast Asia area.

There is also a type of pottery called **lapita** pottery, which was made in Indonesia and found throughout Melanesia including Fiji, and remnants in Samoa show that people traveled in an easterly direction bringing this skill with them.

Another theory, which is not as popular with the anthropologists, is that Polynesians came from the Americas. This was a theory that was put forth by Thor Heyerdahl, a Norwegian explorer. He built a balsa raft (a small example of this type of raft is hanging in the rafters of the Migrations Hut at the Hoku Pa'a Landing) in Peru and set sail to see if it was possible to make it to Polynesia—which he did. Many Polynesians support this theory because their oral history (in the form of chants) tells them that they came from the east.

There is also evidence to show people could have come from this direction also. Throughout Polynesia you will find the sweet potato, which originates in South America. In the highlands of Peru, there is a group of Indians called the **Quetchua** Indians and in their language they call the sweet potato **kumara**. Throughout Polynesia it is called the same thing. For example in New Zealand the Maori call it **Kumara**. They also call it by the same name in the Cook Islands, Marquesas, and on Easter Island. In other islands they use a variation—in Tonga, **kumara**, in Samoa, **umala** and Hawaii **Uala**. In New Zealand the Maori have another type of potato, which they call **peruperu** because as one grandmother said, "our people came from Peru". The papaya is also believed to come from South America and the cotton found throughout Polynesia is an American breed of cotton.

Besides food, Polynesian carvings reflect their American heritage. The Maori have a character called **Tiki**, which is found throughout the Americas also. In fact if you compare a Maori **tiki** to one found in Peru or Mexico, you would have a hard time distinguishing them. In fact in Mexico they are called **heitiki**. In the Tuamotu Islands they built stone walls without mortar where the stones are fitted so close together it is difficult to force a knife blade in between. This is the type of construction that the Maya, Inca, and Aztec Indians (of the Americas) were famous for.

Another fact is that the blood type of Polynesians is predominately "O" positive and the Indians of America as well but the predominate blood type of Southeast Asia is "A" and "B". There has been some study of DNA, which has found that there are three genetic markers within Polynesia showing that Polynesians had their origins in more than one gene pool. They have markers in common with some American Indian tribes and with Asia.

You can see why the question of where Polynesians come from is shrouded in controversy. There are some people that believe that people could have migrated from both areas, Southeast Asia and the Americas and then blended into what we call Polynesians today. We will let you come to your own conclusions on what you think the answer to this question is.

Regardless of where they came from, Polynesians were very sophisticated explorers. They traveled on large catamaran-style voyaging canoes—some 150 – 200 feet long and 35 feet wide. They were capable of carrying large numbers of people and were very fast. They could travel about 160 miles per day. Captain Cook recorded in his journal that when he was traveling from Tahiti up to the Hawaiian Islands that one of these canoes passed him also headed for Hawaii. This canoe reached Hawaii and then passed Cook on its way back to Tahiti before Cook even made it to Hawaii. Cook's ship would take about 60 days to reach Hawaii while the Polynesian vessel only took 20 to 35 days.

The Polynesian navigator started training when he was a child. He had to know where all the stars in the sky were in any given season. Mark Ellis, the Director of Voyaging Experiences and Captain of 'Iosepa, says, "Thousands of observations are made on the deck of the canoe every single day – like where the sun is setting, where the wind is heading, or how the swells are hitting the hull of the canoe. Those thousands of observations are used to make hundreds of choices, such as how to steer the canoe, or whether to put up a bigger or smaller sail. At sunrise and sunset, during the transition time of dawn and dusk, we ask ourselves two questions: Where are we? And In what direction are we going?

Nainoa Thompson, famed CEO of the Polynesian Voyaging Society and Captain of Hokule'a, says, "The only way to where you are is to know where you sailed from." We can apply these same concepts to life.

They would use these stars for navigation. Certain stars marked certain islands. "For example", Ellis said, "the North Star, or **Hokupa'a**, will always be in the north. If the canoe is heading towards Hokupa'a, then you are going north. If it's behind you, then you are going south. If you put your arm up and point at Hokupa'a, everything to your right is East, and everything to the left is West. This is a simplified concept of how we use the stars to navigate." The sky is actually broken up into 32 points on the Hawaiian compass and tracking certain stars or constellations can accurately tell a skilled navigator where he or she is.

During the day, the navigated by the sun. "Since is rises in the East and sets in the West, if you want to go North, position your canoe so that the sun rises on your right and sets on your left", Ellis explained.

There were also other indications of land, which the Polynesians would look for. For example if they saw land-based birds out fishing during the day they knew that these birds only travel about 40 miles away from where they nested. They could wait for nightfall and follow these birds home to land. Clouds were also used. Cumulus clouds only form above land and extend up for thousands of feet so they were easily seen above the horizon. If the navigator saw this type of cloud, he knew there was land underneath. Also any type of cloud will reflect color something like a mirror. So if the navigator saw a cloud that reflected a green or grayish color underneath, chances there was land under that cloud.

Even if he saw one that reflected red, chances were that it was land with some volcanic activity. These are only a few of things that the Polynesian navigator used and looked for as he traveled across the ocean.

IOSEPA

Wa'a Kaulua: Voyaging Outrigger Canoe

The migration of the Polynesians is impressive considering that the islands settled by them are spread out over great distances—the Pacific Ocean covers nearly a half of the Earth's surface area. The principles of traditional Polynesian navigation were simple, but its practice was refined with generations of experience. The greatest skill of the old navigators was their ability to read the ocean currents, winds and the stars in the night sky. The rising and setting points of the brightest and most distinctive stars and planets were marked with the help of sophisticated star compasses, and then memorized. Compasses were also used to chart the winds.

Despite their large size, Polynesian double-hulled canoes (or twin-hulled canoes, as they are sometimes called) were fast and easy to maneuver, and could sail through rough waters. They ranged in length from 20 meters (65.5 feet) for short trips, up to 40 meters (131.2 feet) for longer journeys. In comparison, Captain James Cook's ship, the *Endeavour*, was 33 meters (108 feet) long.

The Building Process: In ancient Hawaii, building a canoe was a specialized art supervised by a high priest called the **kahuna kalai wa'a**, who was granted a place of high rank in the village. When the chief

requested a canoe be made, the kahuna kalai wa'a led an expedition deep into a mountain forest to select an appropriate tree, usually **koa**. A tree might look tall, strong and wide enough, but before a final decision was made, the kahuna kalai wa'a waited for **Lea**, wife of the war god **Ku** and patron of the forest, to approve the choice.

It was believed that Lea would appear as an **'elepaio**, a native Hawaiian woodpecker, who walked over the tree's trunk and branches. If the bird paused and pecked at the tree that was an indication that the tree was either rotten or infested with insects, and the party would continue their search. But if the bird landed on the tree, inspected it, and flew away without pecking at it, the kahuna kalai wa'a knew it was sound enough to be made into a canoe. Using stone adzes, his men painstakingly chipped away at the base of the tree's solid trunk. When it finally yielded, they roughly shaped it where it fell, being careful not to crack it.

The hallowed log was then left in the cool forest to cure for many months because if newly cut koa was immediately transported to a hot, dry area, the dramatic change in temperature would likely cause the wood to split. When the curing process was done, most of the villagers helped move the felled tree to it's new home by the sea, where he work on it was completed.

Believed to be a living creation, each canoe was given a name and treated with great respect. The early Hawaiians' lives revolved around the canoe; it literally was a vessel of life that was used for recreation, fishing, trade, battle and as a means of maintaining communication between the islands.

Iosepa: A Floating Classroom Two years after BYU-Hawaii launched its Hawaiian Studies program in 1999 under the direction of esq., with the help of a grant from the W.K. Kellogg Foundation, two master carvers — **Sione Tuione Pulotu**, a Tongan and retired employee of the Polynesian Cultural Center; and **Kawika Eskaran**, a Hawaiian — began the nine-month process of creating the ***Iosepa*** from eight large **dakua** or tropical hardwood logs imported from Fiji. Traditionally, such a canoe might have been carved from the beautiful Hawaiian *koa* wood, but no suitably sized logs were available.

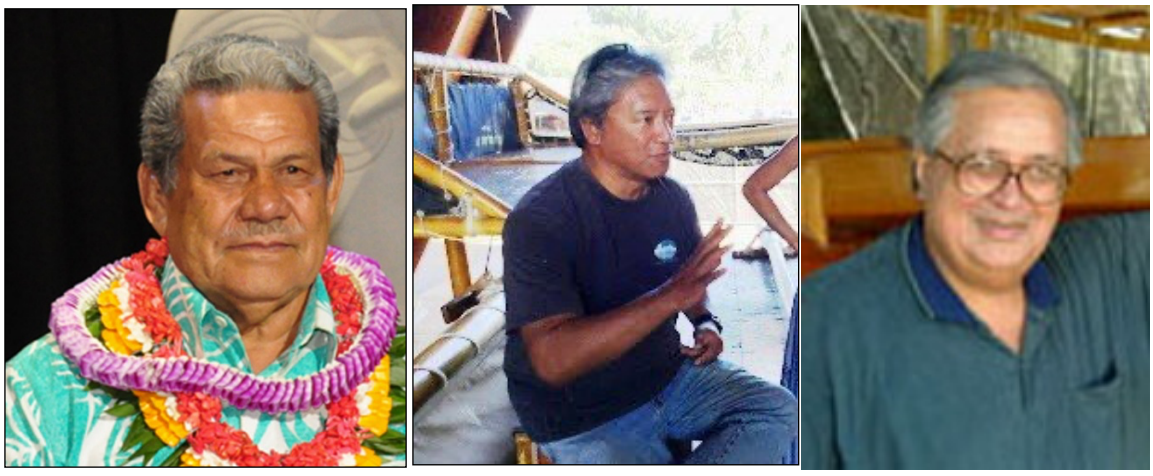


Image 1: Pulotu. Image 2: Eskaran. Image 3: Pulotu & Wallace with the large dakua wood logs used to make Iosepa.

They created a 57-foot long (17.4m) traditionally shaped Hawaiian **wa'a kaulua** or twin-hulled voyaging canoe, with a single **pe'a** or Polynesian "crab claw" sail plus a jib and two large steering oars.

All provisions and gear are either stored on deck or in the hulls. Bunks are also set into the hulls, although the crew of about 12 (optimum) must sleep in shifts. Crewmembers, who are generally limited to one small sea bag of personal possessions each, wear safety harnesses tethered to the canoe when it's on the water. The Iosepa has no metal parts, which posed a problem on its maiden voyage, since the United States Coast Guard needs to be able to track vessels this size via radar. The sail was hollowed out and filled with a light material (similar to aluminum foil) brining it in compliance with Coast Guard regulations. An escort vessel capable of towing the canoe accompanies its educational voyages, but does not assist in navigation.

Hundreds of members of our local community, as well as many others, participated in the process of building Iosepa. Polynesian delegations from around the South Pacific stopped by, school groups were invited to come and visit and participate. They all got to learn directly from Master Carvers Tuione Pulotu and Kawika Eskaran, who headed the project. This was an altogether unusual process, since most times, only skilled artisans and builders were allowed to participate. The Iosepa was truly a project which was for the people, by the people. While normally, a canoe of this size would have taken up to 5 years to build, miraculously, the Iosepa was completed in only 9 months. And on November 3rd, 2001 over 3,000 spectators thronged to Hukilau Beach to participate in the protocol, ceremonies, and lu'au that marked the launching of Iosepa. Since its initial launch, the *Iosepa* — crewed by faculty and staff in BYUH's Hawaiian Studies program — has made sailing voyages along the Windward Oahu coast and to Kawaihae on the Island of Hawaii, home of the Hawaiian sailing canoe *Makalii*. The founders of the *Makalii*, who all trained on the sailing canoe *Hokule'a*, as well as its sponsoring organization, *Na Kalai Wa'a Moku o Hawai'i*, have provided significant and ongoing training for the *Iosepa* crew and captains.

In Hawaiian tradition, the left hull of the canoe is considered the **wahine**, or female, given the name **Kekaipahola.** The right hull is the **kane**, or male component, named **Anianiku**. The canoe is symbolic of a family, whereby the male and female join together to support the entire family in unity.

Image: Iosepa out on the waters of La'ie Bay with Captain Kawika Eskaran & crew.

Some Frequently Asked Questions About 'Iosepa:

How many people can sail on 'Iosepa?
Generally, there is a crew of 12 sailors on the canoe at any given time. The crew works and sleeps in shifts to ensure the canoe is always on the right track.

What are some of the jobs and responsibilities on the canoe?
Anchor Watch is when crew members are posted on lookout duty on a rotation throughout the night. Crew members will work a six hour shift and record information about the canoe for the next crew shift to be aware of. This is vital for the safety of the canoe.

Crew members retie lines, open and close the sails as necessary, and man the helm. The rest of the crew either sleeps, or plays music and games or tells each other stories to pass the time.

How do you cook and what kinds of food do you eat while on a voyage?
Cooking on the canoe is similar to cooking while camping. There is a portable stove and a planned menu so that no one gets bored of the food.

How do you shower when on the canoe?
A bucket is used off the back of the canoe to pull up water from the ocean. Crew members use environmentally friendly soap to lather up and get clean.

How do you go to the restroom?
There's an area on the back of the canoe with a seat with a hole in it over the open ocean. Sailors can sit on it and do what needs to be done, covered by fabric flaps on all four sides for privacy.

IOSEPA TIMELINE:

1970's: The Movement to preserve the Hawaiian and Polynesian legacies by reconstructing ancient canoes begins with the building of Hokule'a.

1990's: Uncle Bill Wallace leads the Brigham Young University Hawai'i's Hawaiian Studies Department to launch a project to build an all wood canoe.

February 7, 2001: Seve massive logs arrive at a vacant lot next door to the Polynesian Cultural Center. They are logs from the dakua tree, a hardwood from Fiji.

March 2001: Master Carvers Tuione Pulotu and Kawika Eskaran begin work on the logs.

October 2001: Uncle Bill Wallace has a dream of his grandfather who gives him instructions to name the canoe 'Iosepa, after former President of the Church Joseph F. Smith.

November 1, 2001: President M. Russell Ballard of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles, great grandson of Jospeh F. Smith, for whom the canoe is named, dedicated and launched the Iosepa.

June 28, 2008: 'Iosepa is showcased to the public at the PCC.

Fall 2015: 11 crew members, comprised of students from various countries, begin working every day to prepare the canoe for a journey.

June 15, 2016: 'Iosepa launches from Hukilau.

May 30, 2024: 'Iosepa sets sail again as part of the Festival of Pacific Arts & Culture. The crew sails around O'ahu for 29 days with stops in Hale'iwa, La'ie, Kualoa, He'eia Kea, Mokapu, Honolulu, and Pokai Bay.

February 2025: 'Iosepa is inducted into the Ohana Wa'a, comprised of intergenerational indigenous leadership representatives of the voyaging canoes and organizations of Hawai'i. Their mission is to work together to elevate the collective health and life of Polynesian voyaging traditions.

POLYNESIAN CULTURAL CENTER

Tahiti

Greeting Word: Ia Orana
Current Population: 180,000-Tahiti (280,000- French Polynesia)

The island of Tahiti, administrative center of French Polynesia, often represents all of the 116 surrounding tropical high rise islands and atolls in the Society Islands, Austral Islands, Tuamotus, Gambier and Marquesas Islands. Tahiti is located approximately 2,700 miles [4,350 km] southeast of Hawaii or about half-way between South America and Australia. The combined land mass covers about 1,400 square miles [13,660 km²]

Factoid: Tahitian craftsmen sometimes bury newly carved wooden drumsticks in mud for several years before using them to assure just the right degree of hardness and proper tuning.

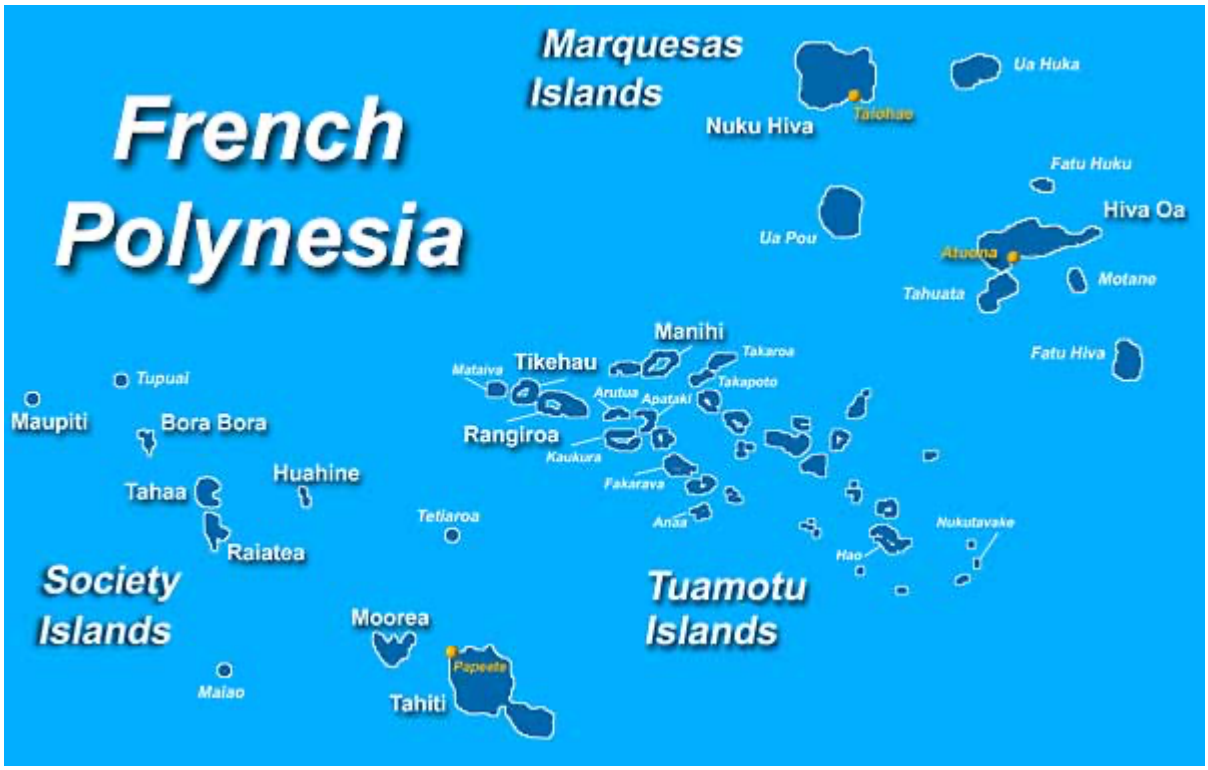
TAHITI

"IA ORANA!" is their greeting word in Tahiti.

Welcome to the Island of Tahiti. Tahiti is just part of one of five island groups (the **Society** Islands, the **Marquesas** Islands, the **Austral Islands**, the **Tuamoutu** Islands, and the **Gambier** Islands) that make up the nation of **French Polynesia** which consists of a total of 116 islands. These islands are spread out over an ocean area as large as the continent of Europe. French Polynesia is a semi-autonomous overseas territory of France, with its own president, parliament and laws. France's influence is limited to subsidies, education and security.

The first European discoverer of Tahiti was Captain Samuel Wallis of the British Royal Navy in 1767, although Tahiti didn't become very well-known in Europe until Wallis was followed by French Navigator Count Louis de Bougainville (1768) who published *Voyage autour du monde*. In his book, Bougainville described the island as an earthly paradise where men and women live happily in innocence, away from the corruption of civilization.

The Tahitian population went into a period of decline in the 19th Century due largely to the introduction of new diseases by Europeans to which the Tahitians had no natural immunity. In this century, however, the Tahitian population has grown at a steady upward rate. The current population of all of French Polynesia is about **280,000**, with **180,000** living on the island of Tahiti. An interesting statistic from French Polynesian today is that more than half of the population is under the age of 20. The approximate racial breakdown of the Tahitian population is 70% Polynesian, 12% European, 10% Polynesian/European, 5% Chinese, and 3% Polynesian/Chinese. All are French citizens.



The first inhabitants of this area are believed to have arrived about in the islands around 830 A.D. Tahitians remained isolated until the late 18th century when the British and French entered into a long series of political maneuvers which lasted over 50 years. Finally, by 1842, the French were in full control, although formal French rule had to wait until 1880, with the abdication of King Pomare V in favor of French rule. On July 14, 1977, France granted Tahiti the right to be self-governing. Tahitians have been French citizens since **1946** and speak the official languages, French and Tahitian.

The primary resources of Tahiti, besides the key industry of tourism, are the products of the coconut such as copra which is sun dried coconut meat, and refined coconut oil known as **monoi** which is used as skin care and suntan lotion. Secondary resources include mother of pearl shells, cultured pearls, fish, vanilla and more recently, the cultivation of the **noni** fruit for its health and nutritional properties.

FARE TAUTAI: Fisherman's Hut

A Tahitian family which lived near the sea would most probably have had a fishing hut made out of bamboo lashed together. The roof is covered with bundled coconut leaves or with sugar cane leaves. This hut would contain minimal furnishings. Sometimes it may have a bed, fish traps hanging from special hooks, a bench or other types of seating, fishing poles, gourds used as containers, nets, ropes and other equipment needed to catch fish efficiently.

Tahitian fish traps were not actually used to trap fish but to store them. The fish were caught first whether by **a'ira** (line) or **upe'a** (net) and then placed inside the bamboo trap or **ha'ape'e**. The door was then closed and the whole trap placed in the water and kept halfway afloat using floats attached on either side. Floats were carved out of **burau** (balsa) or wild hibiscus wood. Thus the fish are kept alive so whenever fresh fish is needed, they are readily available in the bamboo trap.

Each night the fisherman brings all his nets, **nape** or **taura** (ropes), **auri patia i'a** (fishing spears), traps, and other equipment inside his shed for repair and safekeeping. The next morning, he is ready to start a new day of **tai'a** or fishing. From small sheds such as this, fishermen wait for the right time to go fishing, while contemplating the beauty of their islands, or chatting with a friend, or watching over their pearl crop.

Diving for mother pearls, an ancient and high risk method practiced by the people of the Tuamotu to obtain, on rare occasions, a black pearl from a mother pearl, has quickly become a thing of the past since the introduction of black pearl farming by Japanese experts in the late 70's. With the aid of modern technology and a new method of farming the mother pearl, this dying source of industry was quickly revived as the black pearl business began to boom throughout the Tuamotu islands.

Fortunately, due to the lack of pollution in Tahitian waters and the perfect temperature of the blue lagoons, the black pearls have since then been considered to be the most beautiful **poe rava** or black pearls in the world. As such, it has rapidly ranked as one of French Polynesia's highest resource of industry, second only to tourism.

FARE HEIVA: Place of Celebration

This **tahua orira'a** or traditional dance platform is elevated for better viewing of the special daily programs which take place here. The songs and dances of Tahiti which you will see here will be performed in their native language. All Tahitians also speak French which is taught to them once they enter school. The tradition of entertainment in Tahiti once centered on a special guild of traveling performers called the **arioi**. They sailed on great double canoes from bay to bay and island to island performing dance, pantomime dramas, and chants honoring the god **Oro**, deity of peace, agriculture and fertility.

The Tahitian islanders in this village will demonstrate the **pa'oti** and **tamure**, the graceful yet energetic hip-shaking dance which young and old perform throughout the islands. One of the most widely recognized images of the islands is the world famous Tahitian **tamure**, often confused with Hawaiian Hula. This dance, easily recognized by its "fast hip-shaking," and "grass skirts" (see below for actual material used to make these skirts) is often confused with the Hawaiian Hula, a generally slower dance which focuses more on the hands and story telling than the hips.

The compelling rhythm of the dance is provided by the **to'ere** or a horizontal slit-gong wooden drum, and the **fa'atete** or upright wooden drum similar to the snare drum but covered with goat or shark skin. The **pahu tupa'i**, beaten by hands, and the **tari parau** beaten with drumsticks, are drums made from the cow hide or sharkskin.

Some of the dances or songs will feature the more modern instruments such as the guitar and a special version of the **ukulele**, popularly known as the Tahitian **banjo**, which have become vitally important to our music, since their introduction by European settlers.

Contrary to popular belief, Tahitian dancing skirts are not made of grass. Dancing skirts in Tahiti are made out of the inner fiber of the **fau**, or wild hibiscus tree. The women strip off the outer bark of the hibiscus and soak the remaining branches in water. They then strip off the inner bark and dry it in the sun. After the silky inner bark is dried, it is shredded into very narrow strips. The strips are bundled into small clumps and tied onto a waistband also made of the strips. Skirts worn by women for dancing can weigh as much as seven or eight pounds. The dancers find that the heavier the skirt, the better it sways when they move their hips in the fast-shaking

Tassels and shells are placed on the waistband for decoration as well as to accentuate the movement of the hips. In addition, the weighty waistband helps to weigh down the skirts to prevent them from slipping off during the aggressive dancing. Women's skirts extend down to the ankles, while men's skirts extend just below the knees. On festive occasions, dancers try to wear the most elaborately decorated dancing outfits.

When making shell leis many shells of the same size must be individually punched with a sharp rock to create small holes. The shells are then strung together in intricate methods. Anciently, sennit or **purau** (wild hibiscus fiber) was used to string the shells together. Today, modern nylon proves to be more durable.

FARE POTE'E or FARE ARI'I: Chief's Dwelling House

This chief's dwelling represents the round-ended style of Tahitian architecture reserved usually for Chiefs and Nobles. The larger this type of house is, the higher the rank of the owner. The important furnishings would include many large finely woven mats, the **noho ra'a** or four-legged wooden seats for high ranking individuals, the **turu'a** or wooden headrest, and an elevated bed.

There were 3 parts to a chiefly bed: first a layer of dried banana leaves, secondly a layer of mats piled on top of one another for softness, and thirdly a coverlet or blanket which originally were made of woven **lauhala** leaves. Today, quilts are favored because they are easier to maintain.

Other personal effects which might be found in a noble dwelling include costumes, small boxes of highly valued red feathers, drums, flowers, and **tiki** carvings. **Tikis** are designed and placed to ward off evil spirits. The largest **tikis** are usually located on the **marae** or temple enclosures.

The wives of the early Christian missionaries in Tahiti taught Tahitian women the art of quilting which is called **tifaifai**. Tahitian quilting differs from the Hawaiian version in that they do not pad their quilts with batting, nor do they sew the three layers together. Their quilts have only an applique or pieced-together front which is backed with a complimentary backing.

The design of Tahitian quilts also differs from Hawaiian quilts in that Tahitians favor either large boldly-colored overall designs which they applique, or piece together intricate patchwork designs using tiny cutouts of colored cloth. On very special occasions of celebration, the treasured quilts they have carefully stored are brought out and displayed for all to enjoy.

Monarchs of Tahiti

Name	Lifespan	Reign start	Reign end	Notes	Image
Pōmare I *Vai ra'a toa Taina Pōmare I*	c. 1753 – 3 Sept 1803(aged c. 49–50)	1788	3 September 1803	De facto paramount ruler from 1768, first as ari'i, then as regent for Pōmare II from his birth.	
Pōmare II *Tū Tū-nui-'ē'a-i-te-atua Pōmare II*	c. 1782 – 7 Dec 1821 (aged c. 38–39)	3 September 1803	7 December 1821	Son of Pōmare I. Succeeded Pōmare I at birth as ari'i. Exiled to Mo'orea on 22 December 1808. Reclaimed throne on 15 November 1815 after the Battle of Te Feipī.	
Pōmare III *Teri'i tari'a Pōmare III*	25 June 1820 – 8 Jan 1827 (aged 6)	7 December 1821	8 January 1827	Son of Pōmare II.	
Pōmare IV *'Aimata Pōmare IV Vahine*	28 Feb 1813 – 17 Sept 1877 (aged 64)	11 January 1827	17 September 1877	Daughter of Pōmare II. Longest reigning ruler of Tahiti, ruled under French protectorate from 9 September 1842.	

Pōmare V *Ari'i aue Pōmare V*	3 Nov 1839 – 12 June 1891 (aged 51)	17 September 1877	30 December 1880	Son of Pōmare IV. Last King of Tahiti, France annexed Tahiti and its dependencies on 29 June 1880.	

MARAE: Ancient Temple

Anciently, the Marae were built specifically for High Chiefs as a symbol of their power and authority. Coronations & other important events such as war councils, peace treaties, victory celebrations and voyage preparations, took place there. The Marae was usually a large rectangular area surrounded by a stone wall, and guarded by tikis to discourage entries by the uninvited.

These human like figures carved in basalt, volcanic tuff, or wood are usually found near a marae or other holy places. Experts believe tikis had religious significance and symbolized Gods and/or deceased ancestors. Well preserved Tikis are found throughout Polynesia, particularly in the Marquesas Islands, the largest being 9 feet tall.
A fear of evil or bad luck coming to individuals who disturb tikis may influence some natives. More likely, the hope that tikis should be protected so future generations can view them, explains the respect for tiki's shown by most islanders.

Priest (Tahu'a)
The Priest or Tahu'a, was responsible for the clan's sacred activities which include prayers, and other ceremonies that are often accompanied in ancient times with animal or human sacrifices in order to invoke favors from the Gods.
As an important member of the clan aristocracy, the Priest was assisted by lesser officiators called "Haere", who recited oral traditions, and helped enforce the many "rahui" or tapu (**taboos**).

The Marae was decreed sacred and available only to Priests and Chiefs. The Altar, built with several layers of flat stones, is reserved as seating for the Priest and Royalty during ceremonies, and is therefore considered to be the most holy place on the Marae.

Since the European era, once a year, the opening ceremony of the **Heiva Nui i Tahiti**, considered to be one of the top-three worldwide Polynesian Cultural Events, takes place on the **Marae Arahurahu**, located on the western side of the Island of Tahiti, with the re-enactment of various stages of a Chief's

coronation ceremony. However, smaller Maraes were constructed by ancient Polynesian families or clans, to celebrate other sacred traditions.

The Polynesian Cultural Center is proud to present our very own Tahitian Marae built by and under the direction of Archeologist **Mr. Joseph Tchong**, (a native from Tahiti who has been actively engaged in the renovation of other significant Maraes throughout French Poynesia), and approved by the Minister of Cultures of French Polynesia who was officially represented by **Mr. Heremoana Maamaatuaiahutapu,** Director of the House of Culture and the Office of Tourism, in the groundbreaking and dedication of this marae for the common purpose of preserving & sharing with the world, Tahiti's ancient & sacred traditions, such as the celebration of births, marriages & deaths**,** just to name a few.

This priceless work of art, gifted from **"Te Fare Tauhiti Nui**" and the "**Association of Papenoo Marae Preservation"** to the **Polynesian Cultural Center**, was built with 3,200 river stones that have been carefully handpicked one by one from the rivers deep in the beautiful valley of Papenoo Tahiti, and shipped here to Hawaii, a process that took nearly a year.

FARE TUTU: Cooking Hut
This open structure is an example of a Tahitian cooking house. Each Tahitian family would have an outdoor kitchen like this located where the smoke would not interfere with the main house. Both men and women shared in the cooking chores. A man would typically gather the vegetables, hunt pigs and birds, fish in the deeper waters, and perform the more strenuous cooking chores. Women's responsibilities include food preparation and assisting the men in making the underground oven.

The earth oven in Tahiti is called **ahima'a** which is prepared once a day around mid-morning. Several volcanic rocks are first heated in a roaring fire. When the rocks are glowing and red hot, the firewood debris is removed leaving the rocks for the actual cooking. A layer of banana stump fibers which have been pounded into a stringy mass is placed immediately on the hot rocks.

Next, the food to feed the family for a day is wrapped in a variety of leaves and placed on the banana fiber layer. Vegetables like breadfruit, taro, **umara**, **ufi** and green bananas are scraped and peeled and placed naturally on the rocks among the other food items.

The final layers consist of broad leaves, specially-woven mats made from the leaves of the wild hibiscus tree, or green banana leaves, or old mats, used to seal in the heat until the food is cooked. Traditionally, the dirt or sand dug from the pit is spaded on top of everything to ensure the best results.

NONI: Indian Mulberry Tree

The Indian Mulberry, or Noni, as it is called in Hawaii and Tahiti, grows well on sandy or rocky shores. Apart from saline conditions, the plant also can withstand drought and grows in secondary soils. Thus the noni tree can be seen in clearings, volcanic terrain, lava-strewn coasts and on limestone outcrops.

USE AS FOOD: The fruits are edible, but have a strong pungent smell and taste, so for the most part, they were eaten as a famine food. In some Pacific islands, like Raratonga & Kiribati, the fruit was used as a staple food of choice, where they were cooked into curries and stews. Elsewhere, the fruit is eaten raw with salt (Indochina, Australian Aborigines). The fruits may also be fed to pig livestock. The young leaves can also be eaten as a vegetable and contain protein (4-6%). Seeds may be roasted and eaten.

OTHER USES: The bark of the noni produces a reddish purple and brown dye. In Hawaii, a yellowish dye was also extracted from the roots and also used to dye cloth. The tree was also purposely planted to provide support for pepper vines and shade tree or wind-breaker for coffee bushes.

TRADITIONAL MEDICINAL USES:

- Polynesians used various parts of the noni for medicinal purposes, such as containing fever and as a tonic for upset stomach.
- Leaves, flowers, fruit and bark were used to treat eye problems, skin wounds and abscesses.
- The leaves were soaked and placed on the gums and teeth for toothaches and chewed to treat throat problems, respiratory ailments and constipation.
- Applying heated leaves to the chest was thought to help relieve coughs, nausea, colic, and congestion of the chest.
- In some areas of the Philippines, juice of the leaves is taken for arthritis.
- Pounded unripe fruit is mixed with salt and applied to cuts and broken bones.
- Ripe fruit is used to draw out pus from an infected boil.
- Noni has become a plant of much interest in recent years, as modern scientists researching its medicinal properties and possible health benefits. In a recent study by the College of Tropical Agriculture at the University of Hawaii at Mānoa, researchers found evidence that some noni properties can help to control diseases like diabetes and high blood pressure.

POLYNESIAN
CULTURAL CENTER

Tonga

Greeting Word: Malo e lelei
Current Population: 120,000

The kingdom of Tonga – consisting of Ha'apai, Tongatapu and Vava'u island groups – is the about 3,100 [4,950 km] southwest of Hawaii, or about two thirds of the way to New Zealand. It is also east of Fiji and southwest of Samoa. The approximately 170 islands, most of which are low-lying and fertile, cover a landmass of about 280 square miles [710 km²]

Factoid: The letter 'g' in Tongan is always pronounced like 'ng' as in the English word singer – even when it is the first letter in a word – and never as the word finger.

TONGA

"MALO E LELEI!" is the greeting word in Tonga.

TONGA consists of more than **171** small groups of islands, which cover approximately **290** square miles of land. Most of the islands of Tonga are low coral formations, except the **Vava'u** groups, which are of volcanic origin. The climate is fairly cool, by tropical standards, with temperatures averaging about 80 degrees between May and November and rising to about 90 degrees between December and April.

Tonga has a population of about **120,000** people. It is the last remaining kingdom in Polynesia and is the only island nation with the distinction of having never being formally colonized by a European power. Throughout World War II, at the first King's request, Britain protected Tongan interests under various treaties, but Tonga has always maintained her autonomy. The present King of Tonga is **His Royal Highness King 'Aho'eitu Unuaki'otonga Tuku'aho Tupou VI (regnal name: Tupou VI)** who was the successor to King George Tupou V (his brother).

As we look at the huts or structures in the Tongan Village you will notice that they are shaped very much like others of Polynesia, especially Samoan huts, except that Tongan huts have thatched walls. **Tapa** is usually used to line the inside of the walls of Tongan structures called **fale**. The support structures are lashed together with coconut sennit. In former times, no nails or screws were used to hold the buildings together. Other building materials are used to give the structures a dome-shaped appearance, which being higher, gives more efficient ventilation keeping the inside some what cooler.

FALE FAKATU'I: Queen Salote's Summer House

This building is called the **Fale Fakatu'i** and it is the exact quarter scale model of the former queen's summer house in Tonga. **Queen Salote,** a beloved and revered figure in Tongan history, had this structure built here at the Polynesian Cultural Center by her personal workmen. This fale is raised on a rock platform and supported inside by four large ironwood posts, typical of Tongan architectural style. One of the typical roofing materials in Polynesia is sugar cane leaves as it is used on this structure. This royal house is highly decorated with elaborate sennit lashings, fine reed walls, intricately woven mats, and cowry shells. Dried coconut leaves are placed on the floors and then covered with finely woven mats which add extra softness.

The addition of this special structure at the Polynesian Cultural Center was important enough to the royal family of Tonga that the Crown Prince attended the dedication ceremony in 1963 representing his family. Inside, you will find pictures of Tongan royalty. One picture is of **King George Tupou I**, who emancipated his people and established a constitutional government, based upon Christian principles -- mainly the Ten Commandments. Another picture is of **King George Tupou II**. His daughter, **Queen Salote Tupou III**, ascended to the throne in 1918 at the age of eighteen, and ruled for 47 years until her death in 1965, is also pictured. She was followed by **King Taufa'ahau Tupou IV**, who passed away in 2007. He is credited for doing much to further education in his land, and has been awarded an honorary Doctorate Degree from Brigham Young University for his interest in the progress of his people.

List of monarchs of Tonga (1845–present) [edit]

Name	Lifespan	Reign start	Reign end	Notes	Family	Image
George Tupou I	4 December 1797 – 18 February 1893 (aged 95)	4 December 1845	18 February 1893	Son of Tupouto'a, 17th Tu'i Kanokupolu	Tupou	
George Tupou II	18 June 1874 – 5 April 1918 (aged 43)	18 February 1893	5 April 1918	Double Great-grandson of George Tupou I	Tupou	
Sālote Tupou III	13 March 1900 – 16 December 1965 (aged 65)	5 April 1918	16 December 1965	Daughter of George Tupou II	Tupou	
Tāufa'āhau Tupou IV	4 July 1918 – 10 September 2006 (aged 88)	16 December 1965	10 September 2006	Son of Sālote Tupou III	Tupou	
George Tupou V	4 May 1948 – 18 March 2012 (aged 63)	11 September 2006	18 March 2012	Son of Tāufa'ahau Tupou IV	Tupou	
Tupou VI	12 July 1959 (age 63)	18 March 2012	Incumbent	Son of Tāufa'āhau Tupou IV	Tupou	

API NOFO'ANGA: Family Dwelling

This structure is a typical dwelling house in Tonga. Behind the partition is the parent's bedroom. The bedding consists of layers of mats. Young children usually slept at the center of the **fale**. Each night special mats were spread on which the children could sleep. In the morning the mats were rolled up so that the center of the structure could also be used as the sitting room. As girls in the family reached sixteen years of age, a partition was built to provide them with private sleeping quarters on the other side of the building. Around age sixteen boys slept in a separate structure built especially for them. In general, the only furnishings traditionally found in a Tongan home are mats and tapa cloth, which are used extensively for decorating. The dwelling house is the scene for most family activities. Even the courting of daughters by suitors takes place in the dwelling house so that all family members can meet and evaluate the young man.

FALE FAKAKOLO (also known as FALE FAKATAHA): Meeting House

Most village or community meetings are held in this meetinghouse. Civic problems, community affairs are addressed, and Kava ceremonies are performed here. Kava is often called "the official drink of the Pacific." In a kava ceremony, which is one of the highest forms of showing respect for guests or village chiefs, the ranking chief sits on the elevated portion of the floor. The lower section of the floor is for both men and women commoners. Anciently, village meetings took place once a month, but today, meetings are held more frequently.

Kava has been part of Tongan formal ceremony and social culture for more than 2000 years. The kava is made from the root of Pepper Methysticum, a native pepper plant. The root is first pulled from the ground and washed. The outer skin is then scraped revealing the creamy colored core that is pounded into a powder form. A special carved bowl is used for mixing the kava drink. The amount of water needed to accommodate the number of participants is poured into the bowl. The kava powder is then stirred in. A strainer made from the tangled fibers of the wild hibiscus bark is used to strain the kava and obtain the clearest liquid possible. The kava is served in a half coconut shell cup. Kava, though nonalcoholic, contains a mild narcotic that induces a state of restfulness and well being. There are no hangover effects from kava.

FALE HANGA: Women's Work House (Koka'anga or tapa-making & Weaving)
In Tongan society, this is the **fale** where women usually do their arts and crafts, such as **tapa** cloth making. **Tapa** was used primarily for clothing and bedding. Today, however, **tapa** is used mostly at ceremonial occasions for gift giving such a weddings or funerals and we also use it here in the islands as dancing costumes.

Tapa cloth is made from inner bark of the paper mulberry tree. Because the bark is naturally hard and dry, it is first soaked in fresh water overnight prior to working on it. Women then gather the soaked bark and place it on a **tutua** or large flat log and begin to pound it with an **ike** or wooden mallet. The inner bark soon thins out to the point where holes begin to appear. It takes about 45 minutes or more of continuous pounding. The strips are then hung in the sun to dry. A special glue obtained from half-boiled tapioca is used to glue the strips lengthwise and crosswise to make the tapa cloth.

Tapa varies from one Polynesian group to another. Tongans call it **ngatu**. In Samoa it is called **siapo**. Fijians call this cloth **masi**. In Hawai'i it is called **kapa**. One way of distinguishing the various island types of t**apa** is in the designs. To make the designs on the **tapa** cloth, brown and black dyes are usually used. The brown dye is obtained from the inner bark of the candlenut tree (**kukui**). Black dye is obtained by boiling the brown dye with red hibiscus leaves and flowers.

Stencils (called **kupesi** in Tongan) are made from the mid ribs of the coconut leaves, the threads are from the wild hibiscus bark and the coconut fibers as the backing board. The stencil being placed under the cloth and the brown dye is rubbed onto the cloth. The raised parts of the stencil pick up more dye and so the designs and patterns stand out more prominently on the cloth. Black dye is applied with natural pandanus dried seed brushes after the cloth has dried which completes the intricate designs. The black and brown dyes are permanent once they have dried. These days, the Tongan people are some of the most active Polynesians in preserving the traditional art of tapa-making. If you were to go to Tonga today, you would likely hear the constant pounding of the **ike** or wooden mallet against the **tutua** log as the women of Tonga worked to make their prized tapa cloth.

LALANGA: (Weaving) The two plants that are important to the craft of weaving in Polynesia are pandanus and coconuts trees. The pandanus leaves are favored for the weaving of the household items such as floor mats, storage baskets, tablemats and fans. They were also used for canoe sails, bracelets and footwear. These leaves were cut when they were still green and laid

out to dry in direct sunlight. After 2 weeks when the leaves are dried, they are twisted and hung for weeks. Then they are smoothed out and rolled one after another into larger rolls of about a foot in diameter, and then they are secured, stacked and stored for later use.

When the women are ready to use the leaves they are rubbed with a smooth shell until they are flat and pliable. Then using a different shell they are cut according to their required width. The thinner the strips the more important and valuable the project. The coconut leave is other important weaving material in Polynesia. The leaves are cut right off the tree and utilized. Baskets, hats and bowls are easily made because the leaves can be stripped off the main leaf. Coconut leaves provide an easy finish off a house. They can be layered to make a roof, walls and used as screen out the wind and rain, or made into mats used to line the floor over which fine mats would be used.

FALE PEITO: Cooking Hut

The **Fale Peito** is the cooking hut and is usually build away from other buildings in the home because of the smoke and flame while preparing and cooking of food. The underground oven or '**umu** is usually started once a day in early morning. The main hot meal of the day is eaten at noon. Enough food is cooked in the umu so that there is enough for the whole day. However, the cooks have learned proper placement of various food items in the umu to assure that proper temperatures are maintained as closely as possible for the best possible cooking of the food.

The earth oven in Polynesian is the man's domain because it is so physically demanding from the beginning to the end. You must first dig a bowl-shaped pit, gather firewood preferably dried, good burning twigs and branches and large rocks. The fire is started with dried coconut leaves and the dried braches then the large firewood are placed into a sturdy flat shape. The rocks are then placed carefully over the complete framework and the rocks are heated until they are grayish white in color. The unburned woods are removed and the rocks are leveled to the bowl-shape again. The banana stumps are then place on top of the hot rocks. The pit is then filled with food that had been prepared and then covered them with a lot of banana leaves. The oven is totally covered with dirt to ensure that no steam escapes from the mound.

Image: Food is laid out on banana leaves for all to share. Traditionally, there were no utensils and diners ate using their hands.

This hut is usually divided into two sections, forming a kitchen and a dining area. After its ready, the food is removed and taken to the dining area. Food is served and eaten on long trays called **pola**, covered with banana leaves. Fingers, rather than utensils, are the exclusive means of eating. Meals, which can consist of many different types of foods at once, including pork, suckling pig, fish, crayfish,

beef, octopus, and an array of tropical fruits are eaten sitting cross-legged on mats on the ground. For each meal, new banana leaf "tablecloths" are provided.

Image: Queen Salote hosts Queen Elizabeth II & the Duke of Edinburgh during their royal visit to Tonga.

HAWAIIAN MISSION SETTLEMENT

MISSION HOME:

The Missionary house is similar to a house in which early Christian missionaries lived. The first to actively introduce Christianity to Hawaii were the Congregationalists from New England in 1820. They came with their wives (they were required by their organization to be married). The head of the first group was Hiram Bingham and his wife Sybil, pictured on the wall. The Congregationalists developed a writing system for the Hawaiian language so they could translate the Bible into Hawaiian. Roman Catholic priests and nuns lived in much plainer structures. Some missionaries lived with the local Polynesians in their own homes rather than having separates homes. In this way, they were able to learn Polynesian languages and customs more quickly.

When missionaries first arrived in the islands, they endeavored to maintain some of the lifestyle of their homeland. They continued wearing the same style of clothing and built the same types of structures. In order to accomplish this, they brought many things with them to the various island mission fields. They also imported many goods and learned to adopt and adapt many of the Polynesian ways. Thus, in the building and decorating of homes, schools, and chapels, there was a mixture of things brought from the missionaries' homeland and things indigenous to Polynesia.

Samples of imported goods are found in the podium and organ in the chapel and in the finer crafted furniture, windows, and doors in all the buildings. Calico for draperies, tablecloths, and quilts, and the sea chest used during the journey to the mission were also imported items.

The mission home features a curtained canopy bed covered with a wedding ring quilt the family brought over from their New England home. The wooden chest carried belongings on their journey and the desk was stored with writing materials to send letters to their loved ones. The dining room is set with the family's special china, Blue Danube.

Missionary wives taught Hawaiian women the art of quilting. Originally the missionary wives taught the Hawaiian women how to do patch quilting back in 1820 when they first came. The Hawaiian women really enjoyed quilting and by 1850 had developed their own style. Hawaiian quilts usually represent flowers and plants though there are some that represent cultural or historical themes. These designs are cut symmetrically and are always appliqué. Traditionally there are only two solid colors in the quilt. A king-size Hawaiian quilt takes about 9 months, working 40 hours a week to make. A small block quilts take about 35 – 45 hours to complete. There are quilt kits available in the Mission Home for those who would like to try their hand at Hawaiian quilting.

SCHOOL HOUSE

This is what schools looked like in Hawaii during the 1850s. The floors though were sand or dirt and the students would sit on mats and write on slates. The Congregational missionaries started these schools so that people could learn to read and write in Hawaiian and thus be able to read the Bible.

Before these missionaries developed a written form of Hawaiian, important information such as genealogy and history were memorized in the form of chants. Designated people would learn these chants and then pass them on. It was a very accurate system. When the missionaries developed the writing system everyone was invited to learn it so these schools were not just for children but for anyone who wanted to learn to read and write.

The Hawaiian alphabet consists of 5 vowels and 7 consonants. The vowels are a (as in award), e (as in elephant), i (as in eagle), o (as in oh, u. In Hawaiian our vowels are consistent. There are no silent sounds and there is always a vowel in between any two consonants. The consonants are pronounced like English consonants. The "w" is pronounced like a "w" or a "v" depending what comes before it. Usually, if it is at the beginning of a word it is pronounced like a "w" and if it is in the middle of a word it has a "v" sound.

We have two additional marks that are used. This mark that looks like an apostrophe is called an **'okina**. What it does is break up the sounds of the vowels. If one of these marks is between two vowels, the vowels are pronounced separately. For example, La'ie. This other mark is called a **kahako** and what it does is extend the sound of the vowel as in the word lū'au. These marks change word meaning so they are important.

Now that you know everything about Hawaii pronunciation lets have a little test. (Show them our list of words and have them go over them.) For the final exam let's try to pronounce the name of the State fish—**Humuhumunukunukuapua'a.**

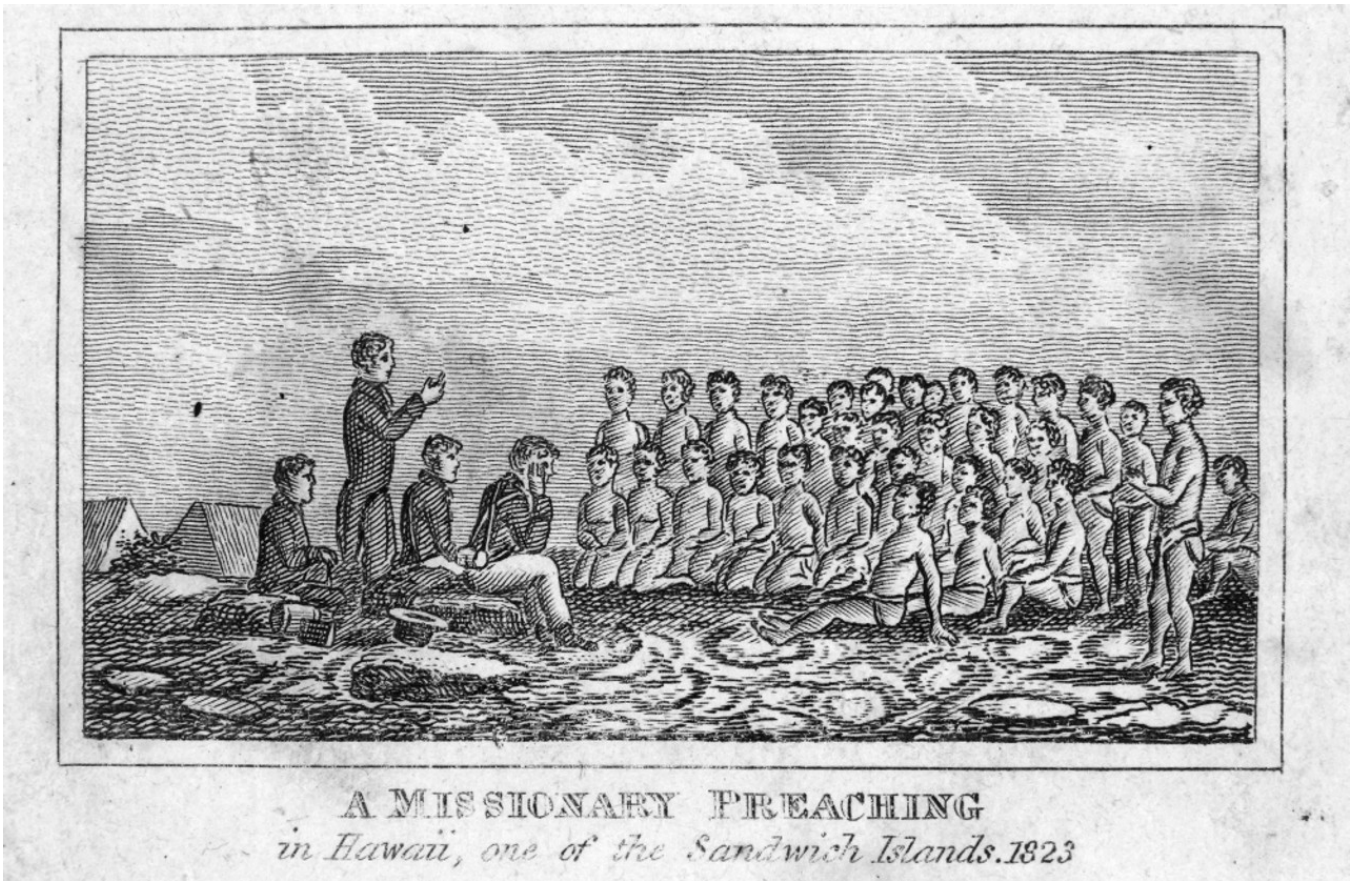


Image: Missionaries preaching in Hawai'i in 1823

CHAPEL:

This small type of chapel was built throughout Hawaii during the 1850s and represents all denominations. The first to actively introduce Christianity to Hawaii were the Congregationalists from

New England in 1820. Many of the Congregationalists made Hawaii their home and their descendents still live here.

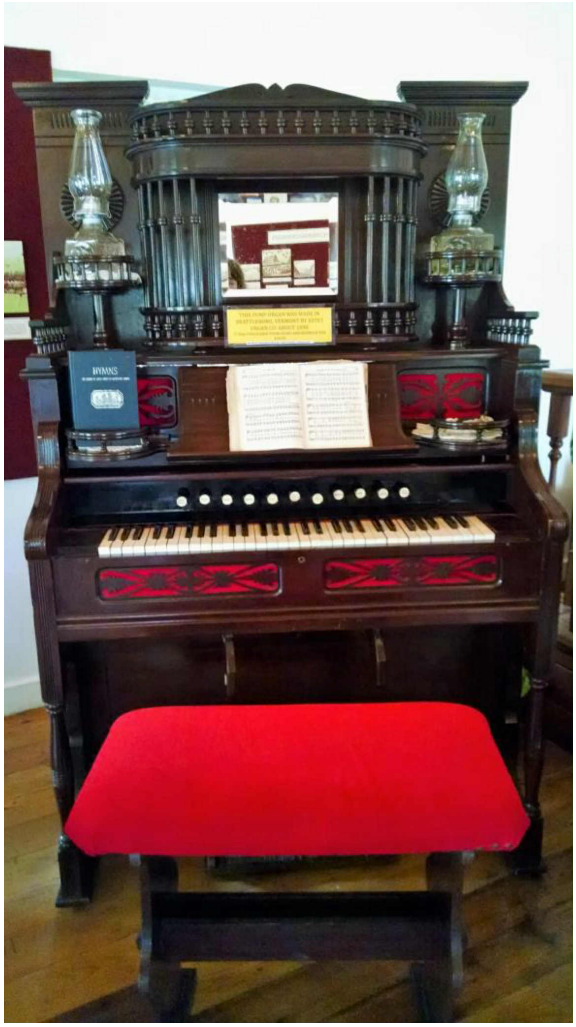
The second group to come to Hawaii were the Catholics. They originally came in 1827 but did not really get established until the 1840s. These missionaries were single priests. One such priest, Father Damien, went to the island of Molokai to help those patients with Hansen's disease, commonly called leprosy, in **Kalapapa**. At that time people who had leprosy in Hawaii were taken there by boat and were dropped off shore and had to swim to shore. There weren't facilities to take care of them and their quality of life was terrible. Father Damien helped to change that and hence became a hero to those people. For 16 years he lived with the lepers until he too died of leprosy, which he contracted while working there. In 2009, Father Damien was canonized, and was named Saint Damien by Pope Benedict XVI. Today leprosy or Hansen's disease is controllable and no one is required to undergo the isolation from society that used to be the norm.

The third group of missionaries to come to Hawaii was from the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints also known as the Mormons. In February 1851, the first convert to the LDS Church was baptized in Hawaii. By August of that same year, there were five congregations with 220 members. A meetinghouse was built in Pulehu on the island of Maui in 1852. This structure still remains today. In 1854, Lanai became the designated gathering place for members, where a colony and plantation began.

The Church purchased land at Laie to establish a colony, a sugar factory, and a school. The Church College of Hawaii (now BYU—Hawaii) opened in September 1955. In 1963, the Polynesian Cultural Center opened to represent the various South Pacific cultures. These structures, in addition to the temple completed in 1919, bring international attention to the Church.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION:

The organ is a pump organ that was built by the Estey Organ Company in Vermont in 1890. It was restored by LDS missionaries and is on display in working order here at the Polynesian Cultural Center.



The Hawaiian wordings hanging behind the podium in the chapel are copies of panels that hung in the old Mormon chapel in La'ie, built in the late 1800's. They say:

"E HO'OMANA'O OIA IA NA MOKUPUNA O KE KAI"
Translated into English, "He will remember the islands of the sea." – Isaiah 11:11

"O KA MEA HO'OMANAWANUI AKU A HIKI I KA HOPENA E OLA IA"
Translated into English, "He who endures to the end, the same shall be saved." – Matthew 10:22

POLYNESIAN
CULTURAL CENTER

Rapa Nui

Greeting Word: Iorana
Current Population: 3,000

Rapa Nui is located about 4,300 miles southeast of Hawaii (it's actually closer to Antarctica). It is approximately 2,000 miles to the East of Tahiti and approximately 2,200 miles off the coast of Chile, making it one of the most isolated islands in the world. Its nearest neighbor, tiny Pitcairn Island is over 1,200 miles away.

Factoid: Rapa Nui, according to research and oral traditions, was once covered with trees, which have since all been cut down, possibly to aid in the construction and transportation of the almost 900 *moai* or stone monuments.

RAPA NUI

"IO RANA!" is the greeting word in Rapa Nui.

There has been much controversy and confusion concerning the origins of the Easter Islanders. Thor Heyerdahl proposed that the people who built the statues were of Peruvian descent, due to a similarity between Rapa Nui and Incan stonework. Some have suggested that Easter Island is the remnant of a lost continent, or the result of an extra-terrestrial influence. Archaeological evidence, however, indicates discovery of the island by Polynesians at about 400 AD - led, according to legend, by *Hotu Matua*. Upon their arrival, an impressive and enigmatic culture began to develop. In addition to the statues, the islanders possessed the Rongorongo script; the only written language in Oceania. The island is also home to many petroglyphs (rock carvings), as well as traditional wood carvings, tapa (barkcloth) crafts, tattooing, string figures, dance and music**.**

Easter Island forms the eastern apex of the Polynesian Triangle. Rapa Nui is a small volcanic island that encompasses about 67 square miles of land mass, and at its highest point rises to about 1,700 feet. It is famous throughout the world for its historic stone statues, which the Polynesian people there call *moai*.

Rapa Nui is located about 4,300 miles southeast of Hawaii (it's actually closer to Antarctica). It is approximately 2,000 miles to the East of Tahiti and approximately 2,200 miles off the coast of Chile, making it one of the most isolated islands in the world. Its nearest neighbor, tiny Pitcairn Island is over 1,200 miles away. Rapa Nui, according to research and oral traditions, was once covered with trees, which have since all been cut down, possibly to aid in the construction and transportation of the almost 900 *moai* or stone monuments.

Oral tradition says the years between discovery and first contact with the western world were filled with growth to a population as large as 10,000, as well as the creation of the *moai*, but also with civil warfare, cannibalism and the complete deforestation of the land. Just under **3,000** people live on Rapa Nui today, most of them Polynesians. Like many of the other Pacific islands during the 18th through early 20th centuries, European diseases and indentured labor practices decimated the population. At one point in the early 1900s there were only 111 Rapa Nui people left on the island; and while the slowly growing population has managed to hang on to much of their Polynesian culture, a great deal was also lost forever.

For example, the people of Rapa Nui may have been the only Polynesians to have something akin to a writing system in the form of their *rongorongo* tablets, a few samples of which have survived to present times in widespread museums. The ability to translate them, however, seems to have been lost forever as there is no one alive today who can read or translate the tablets.

Dutch Admiral Jacob Roggeveen came upon Rapa Nui on Easter Sunday, 1722, hence the English name Easter Island. In 1852 Chile annexed the island, and it remains a territory of that nation to this day.

THE PCC EXHIBIT:

The Polynesian Cultural Center added this Rapa Nui exhibit as part of its 40th anniversary celebration in 2003.

In preparing for the new exhibit, the Polynesian Cultural Center, with the consent of the government and cultural elders of Rapa Nui, invited four respected stone carvers to Laie, Hawaii, where they created seven authentic *moai*: two of them approximately 6 meters long are reclining (one of them

intentionally left partially finished) and the other five about 3.5 meters high have been erected on an *ahu* or burial platform patterned after the famous one in Rapa Nui: *Ahu Nau Nau* at Anakena.

When the four Rapa Nui carvers finished their work in the spring of 2003, they named the platform where the five *moai* now stand *Ahu Tu'u Koihu* in honor of the first Rapa Nui chief who oral history says started the tradition of building the statues that have become icons of Polynesia to the rest of the world.

AHU: Burial Platform

The ahu, or burial base or platform, you see before you were traditionally used as a burial place for the Ariki or King and Tagata Honui or Chiefs. This one is patterned afteran actual ahu called Ahu Nau Nau in Anakena on Easter Island, which is believed to be the bay where the first Polynesian settlers of Rapa Nui arrived under the leadership of Chief Hotu Matu'a of what is now French Polynesia.

Moai is the word given to describe these carved stone statues in general. The moai here on the ahu represent each Ariki or Tagata Honui that were traditionally buried beneath it. Each stone carving is unique and have their own distinguishable characteristics that resemble the individuals they are representing. After the Moai are erected in their final resting place, they are given the same name as the person they portray.

The pukao, or large red scoria stone on the head of the Moai, represents the statue's hair. Ancient Rapa Nui men had long reddish colored hair bleached by the sun, which they would bundle up and wear on the top of their head.

The mata, or eyes on the moai, are carved from white coral found on the ocean's floor. The carvers told how they each dived and brought pieces of white coral with them to Hawaii to make the "eyes" for the *moai*; and after they placed these eyes into the sockets they had carved, then the *moai* were no longer "blind," but now "could see". The eyes give life to the *moai* and, therefore, to the people who were [traditionally] buried under the *ahu*." The inner layer, or pupil of the eye is made of the finest red scoria stone on Easter Island.

MOAI:

Since they came to the attention of the outside world, the *moai* have captured the fascination of everyone who sees them. These stone statues range from just a few feet high to almost 80 feet high, and are made from scoria — or hardened volcanic ash. Unfortunately, scoria is not very durable, and ongoing

conservation of the existing *moai* is a major concern. It's believed that all the moai on Rapa Nui were carved from the same quarry, Rano Raraku. There are still some unfinished Moai in the quarry today. In all, the islanders created almost 900 statues, although the majority of those were never transported from the quarry or even finished.

It is unclear why the Easter Islanders turned to statue construction on such a massive scale. Their obsession with it arguably contributed to their downfall as they depleted more and more of the forests for use in the process of moving the giant moai. While the 'why' is a mystery, 'where' it happened and to a large degree 'how' it happened is fairly clear. Each moai was born from the massive caldera of Rano Raraku.

The soft volcanic tuff was perfect material for statue carving. Using harder volcanic rock implements they were able to first sketch out the moai's outline in the rock wall and then systematically chip away at it until the moai was held in place by a thin "keel."

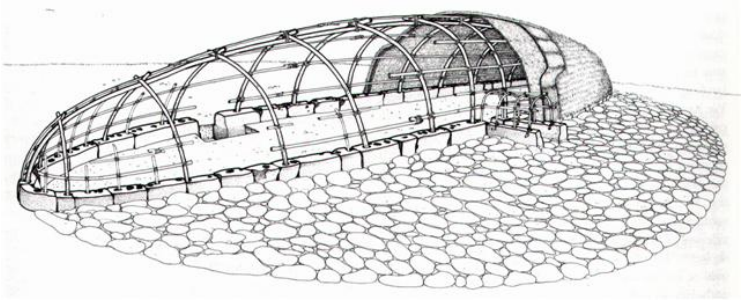
The moai carvers were master craftsmen that had rose through the ranks of a "carver's guild." The production of the statues was most likely through conscripted labor with many rituals and ceremonies performed throughout the process. The stone carvers were ingenious in making the most out of sections of rock. moai can be seen carved in all directions in the cliff face. If a defect would appear in the rock the statue would be abandoned and they moved on to another area. They took advantage of fissures in the volcanic walls and also variations in colors. In short they were true artists.

Many theories have been put forth about why they were carved and how people without sophisticated machinery could move the heavy megaliths. One island tradition says those *moai* that were eventually set up on *ahu* platforms facing the ocean "walked" there. Those with more of an engineering orientation say this is feasible, suggesting the people may have used a series of long ropes and log rollers to tip a *moai* a little toward one side and then pivot it forward on the resting point, much as one person can move a heavy object by rocking it forward without having to pick it up. This and similar theories also suggest that all of the trees on the island were eventually cut down to provide the log rollers. Another widely publicized author at one time suggested extraterrestrial beings were somehow involved in the process.

The largest one is still in the mountain quarry and measures approximately 70 feet tall. On Rapa Nui, there are several moai that can be found on the ground in much the same way as this Moai is displayed. This was a consequence of tidal waves and other natural disasters, erosion and tribal wars, which resulted in rivals toppling the Moai on their enemies.

HARE VAKA: Dwelling House

Hare Vaka, or boat house, is the name Rapa Nui people called this structure, because when completed it looks like an overturned canoe. This structure is a scaled down model. Traditionally theses structures extended 30 – 60 feet. There are records however of Hare Vaka that measured up to 300 feet, or roughly, the size of a football field.



The people of Rapa Nui say the aerodynamic shape of the hare vaka helps counter strong island winds. The lack of trees and any significantly large mountains or hills meant there was no natural barriers to the strong winds that swept right over the islands.

MANA VAI: Protected Garden Pit

This structure was created to protect the delicate plants from strong winds. Rapa Nui has an average elevation of 200 feet above sea level. The winds that are generated at sea have little to no resistance from the islands.

Rapa Nui people found that they could protect the plants from the winds by creating rock walls around them. These walls would also help the plants gather water from the infrequent rains during the summer months. The Mana Vai housed Rapa Nui staple foods such as taro, banana, sugar cane, and sweet potato.

This Mana Vai has been left half finished to allow those taking the canoe tour a better view of the interior structure.

HARE MA'EA: Stone Structures

This is the name Rapa Nui people call this house, because it is constructed entirely of rocks, including the roof. These structures were created mostly for ceremonial purpose during the Tangata Manu, or birdman period. Several structures like this can be found on the edge of Oronga crater in Rapa Nui. This is where the traditional Tangata Manu, or birdman competitions were held.

BIRDMAN COMPETITIONS:

High on the rim of the crater known as Rano Kau was the ceremonial village of Orongo. Built to worship the god of fertility, Makemake, it became the site of a grueling competition.
Each year leadership of the island was determined by the individual who could scale down the vertical slopes, swim out to one of three small islets in shark-infested waters, and bring back the egg of the nesting sooty tern unbroken. The one who did this successfully was considered the Birdman of the year and was bestowed with special honors and privileges.

One of the most fascinating sights at Orongo are the hundreds of petroglyphs carved with birdman and Makemake images. Carved into solid basalt, they have resisted ages of harsh weather. It has been suggested that the images represent birdman competition winners. Over 480 Birdman petroglyphs have been found on the island, mostly around Orongo.

PACIFIC THEATER BACKSTAGE TOUR

Script and route for Super Ambassador & VIP guests

Tour Route & Info Share-Points:

1. Enter the Pacific Theater backstage area using either the stairs or ramp outside Portal 1.
2. Pause on the right, just outside the Fire Prep Area. Share info about fireknives & other fire elements.
3. Go to the Kahuku Tunnel. Introduce Firewalk & ti leaf skirts.
4. Go to the line-up area to observe cast line-up/rehearsal. (If the cast is holding their devotional, do not disturb them with loud narration. Groups should pause in silence until the prayer is finished.)
5. Continue to the wardrobe window to view costumes, conveyors, props. Explain.
6. Exit the backstage area via the bridge by Portal 6 (or by returning to the wheelchair accessible pathway by Portal 1 for wheelchairs or strollers).
7. Enter the theater from Portal 6. Allow guests to see the inside of the theater. Give general information about the "front of the house" (i.e. those things guests can see from where they're standing).
8. Walk through the inside of the theater to section 3 to drop them off.
9. Conclude tour & express genuine gratitude for guests' visit.

Cautionary Items:

Remember that we are all guests of the Theater Department when we go backstage. Please be sure to follow all instructions from Theater personnel, and follow the guidelines regarding traffic flow and authorized/unauthorized areas.

1. *Do **not** cross yellow lines painted throughout the backstage area. Yellow lines designate off-limit areas and neither guides nor guests are allowed there.*
2. *Do **not** go onto the stage, through the tunnels, or allow your tour group to be seen by the audience in the theater.*
3. *For safety reasons, tour groups **should not** use the grottos or cave areas, walk up the mountains or stairways, or access the catwalks at **any time**.*
4. *For privacy, tours are **not** allowed in the dressing rooms or backstage restrooms at **any time** and for **any reason**. Do not stop the tour in front of the dressing room doors at **any time**.*
5. *Do **not** open **ANY** doors **ANY**where backstage.*
6. *Do **not** touch any of the props or dance implements.*
7. *All tour groups should be out of the backstage area by **7:10 pm**.*

The following facts can be incorporated into the Backstage Tour and are listed in an order that flows with the designated tour route, starting at the backstage area from Portal 1, and ending at Portal 6, where guests enter the frontside of the theater to conclude the tour.

Theater Backstage:

The performers have several entrances and exits, as well as different levels and stairways on the mountain, adding different dimensions to each cultural section's performance. *(Point towards the tunnel entrance).* This area on the North side of the mountain is known as the **Kahuku Tunnel**. Most of the fire props used in the show is put together on this work table *(point to the table)* by our stage crew:

- During the overture some women performers will dance with fire cups made from coconut shell halves, sand and a wick.
- To make the fireknives, we take canec, which is a rigid board made of pressed sugar-cane fiber, cut into pieces that fit on the flat sides of the 18-20 inch knife, secure everything with wire, and soak it in gas.
- The traditional weapon used is the Samoan war club called the **nifo oti**, or killer tooth, named for the distinct hook at the top of the blade, often adorned with serrated teeth, which was originally used in combat in the 19th century.

- Traditionally, warriors would exhibit their battle skills, prowess, and dexterity in a display called **ailao**. In 1946, Paramount Chief Freddie Letuli added fire to the blades of the **nifo oti** and what we now know as the Samoan Fireknife was born.
- You might also point out the fire boards used for the Samoan Warrior's Fire Walk and fire torches used throughout the show

Located in both tunnels near the side wall is a sand box ready for the performers as they exit the stage to douse the fire torches, etc. And behind these doors *(point to the musician's doors)* is the musician's dressing room and rehearsal which takes them directly to the stage.

Hanging on the wall are ti-leaf skirts used for the fire walk dance in the show. The performers literally walk and sit on fire as a form of fun and entertainment, showing off and displaying their courage and bravery. It takes approximately 100 leaves to make a single skirt. The young men wrap themselves with a **lavalava**, or wrap-around material, and then wear the ti-leaf skirt for protection. This is the only thing protecting them from the flames.

(Walk slowly towards the lineup area and point towards the green emergency shower). With the use of so much fire, there is always a chance that someone could be burned. In the case of an emergency, this shower is situated here, immediately at the exit of the tunnel so a dancer who was injured can come straight here and wash off/cool down from the hot flames. We also have a First Aid responder on stand-by throughout the show in case of more serious injuries.

(At the lineup area) The Lineup area has wall to wall mirrors and this is where we help teach and train performers. It's also equipped with TV monitors to watch what's going on on-stage, monitors to hear the show, and a microphone and public-address system for announcements. Rehearsals, cast meetings, show line-ups, and trainings are conducted daily here beginning at 1:30pm until 9pm at night. On the opposite end, across from the mirrors, *(point to the shelves where the men dress)* male dancers keep their different costumes here and use this area for quick changes during the show instead of running all the way to the dressing room each time. Each performer will go through several costume changes throughout the show and the men use this area for quick modest changes.

The cast is made up of students attending Brigham Young University Hawaii – not a troupe of professional dancers. They go to school during the day, attending classes, studying for exams, and doing homework, just like any college student. In addition, they work here at the Polynesian Cultural Center part-time (19 hours per week). Besides their wages, most receive free room and board, free tuition, and are able to graduate debt free with a college degree! Students who audition for and are

hired to dance in the show are required to learn the music, songs, and dances for a minimum of three of the six Polynesian cultures portrayed in the show. Some come with a little performance experience, but many do not. They're given the opportunity to learn the intricacies of performing these traditional songs and dances from cultural experts here who pass on their expertise and love of the culture. Many of the students become so committed to their craft that they request to learn more of the songs and dances than are required. Less than 10% of the cast volunteer to learn the songs and dances from ***all six*** cultures and perform for the entire 90-minute show! It's quite a feat, and it requires a lot of practice, commitment, and dedication, but they do it because they feel the content of the show holds a special meaning. It's not just entertainment. It's the outward expression of our culture – who we are as a people, and what we believe in. We consider it a great honor to be able to represent our people and share our culture with the world.

(As you walk down the hallway, pass the women's dressing room – do not stop there. No one should enter either of the dressing rooms.) There are two dressing rooms, one for women and one for men; Both have TV monitors, as well as speakers that allow those changing to both see and hear the show and cast announcements. Lockers for performers' personal belongings and showers are also found inside. The cast checks out costumes from countertops with student wardrobe workers ready to issue and distribute costumes to the cast.

(By this time you should arrive to the outside of the costume room with the conveyor belt) The double doors in the middle of this building open up to issue costumes for our feature roles or performers, as well as issue out special costumes and oversized props that need special care, like the huge 30 foot **tapa** you'll see during the Tongan section. If you turn your attention to the ceiling inside you'll see the conveyor racks filled with wardrobe and costumes from all six of the Polynesian cultures represented this evening, which cast members check out.

Part of the mission of the Polynesian Cultural Center is to preserve and portray the cultures, arts, and crafts from this region of the world. Unfortunately, as the islands and people of Polynesia become more and more influenced by Western culture, fewer people are able to pass on the know-how and skills to create cultural items like tapa, fine mats, and traditional costumes. We are proud to have many cultural artisans from the islands homes they represent, that work here at the Cultural Center who not only make all of the props and costumes you'll see in tonight's show, but are able to teach these skills to the next generation so that their expertise and knowledge is able to live on. Students who work at the Cultural Center as part of the work-study-scholarship program are not only able to work their way through school, earning their college degree, but are also able to learn these invaluable cultural skills and take them back to their home countries after they graduate.

Directly across from the checkout counter is what we refer to as the **Hau'ula Tunnel**, and as you can see there is another sand box on the side for performers dousing torches upon their exit from the stage.

Shelves in both tunnels were made specifically for the props that you see here *(you can point to the props and identify each if they are set up – but DO NOT touch them).* The props are lined up in the order that they'll be used for the show by the stage crew, and the dancers will run by and pick them up as they're needed for different dances on their way onto the stage.

The drummer's room on the right is where all the drums are stored, such as the Tongan **nafa** or drums, Tahitian bass drums, **pahu** drums, and stands. Since the drum heads are made of dried cowhide, heat lamps hang from the ceiling immediately over the drums in the corner of the room to keep the drum heads taunt and tight. There is also a special walkway and tunnel for the drummers to walk to their area of performance on stage.

As we exit the backstage area we will pass more shelves and benches just outside of the men's dressing room. Also, you'll see the dressing rooms of the performers in the featured roles of Mana, Lani, & 'Mother'.

You may have noticed the large mirror in the first tunnel (Kahuku), similar to the large mirror here in this tunnel (Hau'ula). Overhead hangs a sign that says, "Thru this tunnel pass the best dancers in Polynesia!" This is not intended to puff us up in prideful way. Rather, the performers use it to remind ourselves to strive to do our very best to make that statement true so that our customers will enjoy the performance. Each and every student-performer, tech staff, stage crew member, and musician owes you, our customers, a great debt of gratitude for making the Polynesian Cultural Center the number one paid attraction in Hawai'i. Thanks to your visit and the millions of guests who have visited us since the Center opened back in 1963, so many students from around the world (and especially those from the South Pacific) have been able to gain a higher education and graduate from college.

(Exit backstage area by Portal 6.)

General Information about the Pacific Theater:

- The Pacific Theater opened in **1977** as the new home for the night show. Previously, the night show was held in the Hale Aloha. The theater underwent a $3 million dollar upgrade to equipment and facilities in 2009.
- Seating capacity is **2,400** for one show. If the count is high, a second show is added at 6pm.
- The mountain is man-made and is as tall as a three story building. The plants on the mountain are all real and are changed according to the shows needs.
- The Pacific Theater is equipped with state-of-the-art sound, lighting and special effects equipment.
    - The most recent renovation added 3 animation projectors, screens and other special effects.
    - There are nearly **50** house speakers, woofers, sub-woofers, midrange and tweeters situated throughout the theater to ensure the best quality surround-sound experience no matter where you are seated.
    - We have over **500** lighting instruments overhead on the catwalks and beams, in the water, onstage, in the landscaping and on the mountain that require daily attention for re-lamping, color and focus.
- To staff the evening show involves over **160** dancers, musicians, technical staff, wardrobe assistants, administrative staff and cultural experts.
    - Approximately **85%** of the entire night show personnel are students – they are not "professional" dancers. Many of them need to be taught the intricacies of Polynesian dance by cultural experts here at the PCC, aligning it with its mission to "preserve and portray the culture".
    - Performers report to work an hour before show time for cast meeting, line-up and change into costumes. Cultural experts work with the cast to ensure authenticity, accuracy and correctness.
    - Technical staff report to work **1½** hours prior to show time to prepare the stage, props, and test electronic equipment and special effects. The Stage crew handles placement and issuance of over **300** dance implements and props.
- All costumes are designed, created and maintained by PCC.
    - There are over **50** different costume designs used in the show with over **1,100** costume pieces to outfit all the performers.
    - The Theater has its own wardrobe department which designs, creates, repairs and launders all of the costumes. They also maintain costumes for the Huki: Canoe Celebration and the Ali'i Lu'au shows.
    - Each performer is assigned a number which is then used to identify all of their corresponding costumes and props for the show. Costumes are hung on conveyor racks for storage and issued just prior to show time.
- We have never had down time with this theater. New shows are created and implemented simultaneously with the ongoing production. Many theaters close the showroom for weeks or even months to stage a new show. This means that technical crews and performers learn, work and rehearse a new show, all while maintaining the existing show!
- The current show **"Ha – Breath of Life"** started in July of 2009. The previous show, **"Horizons!"** had a successful run of fourteen years.

(Close with a sincere thank you. For example …)

For many, this dream would not have been possible without your visit to the Polynesian Cultural Center. And so, on behalf of everyone here – from those you saw in the island villages, those who took you on tour, and those who assisted you in the different restaurants … and those who work behind the scenes in the offices, the kitchens, and custodians, who aren't able to thank you in person— Thank you for making our educational dreams a reality and for helping us to preserve and portray these cultures from Polynesia which we cherish and hold dear to our hearts. Your visit today truly makes a difference, and for that, we will always be grateful.

Mahalo nui loa or thank you very much, and Aloha!